EPISODE 1

1 EXT. ROAD - MORNING 1
(DRUNK MAN A, DRUNK MAN B, EVA, MIKE, TEN BODYGUARDS)

SEVERAL MOTORCYCLES RACE DOWN THE STREET. *

EVA MILLER, wearing a sexy biker's outfit, stops her motorcycle and removes her helmet stylishly. *

CLOSE-UP HER LONG HAIR CASCADES DOWN, REVEALING HER BEAUTIFUL FACE. * *

Two DRUNK MEN pull up on bikes on either side of Eva. Drunk Man A licks his lips and looks at Eva.

DRUNK MAN A
Hey gorgeous, take a break in my big arms if you're tired.

Eva looks at him and scoffs.

EVA
Clean your filthy mouth. That's no way to talk to a lady.

DRUNK MAN B
(angrily)
Ha, ballsy. Gotta show you some real balls to shut you up.

The men LAUGH lewdly as they approach Eva.
Just then, **four luxury cars** speed over and surround them.

CLOSE-UP/FLASH CUTS: TEN BODYGUARDS IN BLACK SUITS LINE UP IN A V-FORMATION BEHIND EVA'S BUTLER MIKE SULLIVAN (60S) WHO GETS OUT OF THE CAR. * * *

They stride towards Drunk Men and Eva. Drunk Man A is scared shitless. Eva receives Mike's bow with poise.

MIKE
Miss Miller, please allow us to escort you home per Mr. Miller's command.

Eva smiles serenely. Quivering, Drunk Man A points at her.

DRUNK MAN A
What? You... you're Eva Miller, the legendary heiress of the Miller family!

Drunk Man B is terrified.

DRUNK MAN B
(speaking quickly)
The Millers? One of the three families that run the entire LA's economy?

DRUNK MAN A
No one even has a chance to see Millers' daughter. She is just as mysterious as the heir of the Jones family.

DRUNK MAN B
(to Eva)
Please don't blame us for being blind, ma'am!

The two Drunk Men start their motorcycles and flee. Mike starts after them but Eva gestures for him to stop.

EVA
(to Mike)
Just a few drunks. Let them go. Have you done what I asked?

MIKE
Madam, I've discreetly assisted your husband, Kevin Brown, in securing the ten-million deal with the Jones family. Now that he's the most desirable hire in town, you don't need to hide yourself to protect his ego anymore.

EVA
(nodding approvingly)
Sounds great! I'd like to share the good news with him myself, as today is the date we celebrate our three-year anniversary.

Eva starts to get on her motorcycle to leave, but Mike quickly stops her.

MIKE
The Jones family is hosting a signing banquet for your husband, and Mr. Jones Sr, the patriarch himself, has sent you a personal invitation, but your father wishes for you to have some rest first.

EVA
(putting on her helmet)
Tell my dad, I'll be home as soon as possible. Won't be late for our family gathering.

Eva gets onto her motorcycle and drives off. Mike and his men chase futilely as Eva rides away with a salute goodbye. *

2 EXT. CITY HALL ENTRANCE - DAY 2 *
(DAVID, EVA, KEVIN, RYAN) *

Eva's **helmet** hangs from her parked motorcycle.

Eva stands at the city hall entrance, holding **a bouquet of flowers** and beaming with happiness.

EVA (V.O.)
(lost in happy fantasies)
Celebrating Anniversary at the city hall? Kevin is so romantic and sweet. Lifting him up from the bottom to a top manager now sure feels worth it. Hope our marriage can become even stronger, once I tell him who I really am.

A luxury black car stops behind Eva. The handsome RYAN JONES (20-30s) steps out from the backseat with his assistant DAVID KERR (20s) opening the door.

Episode 2 *
EXT. City HALL EnTRANCE - DaY *
(DAVID, EVA, KEVIN, RYAN) *

David eyes on the Rideshare logo on the windshield.

DAVID
(in a low voice)
Mr. Jones, we have so many better cars at your disposal. Why insist on taking a taxi?

RYAN
(seriously)
I don't want my date to be in it only for the money.

Eva turns around, bouquet in hand, and her eyes meet Ryan's. Ryan plays it cool, holding his head up.

RYAN (CONT'D)
(stepping forward)
Hi, I'm Ryan. 30 years old, PhD in business administration from Stanford. I 'm working for the Jones Group currently. How about you?

Eva is taken aback.

EVA
Who me? Um... I'm Eva. FIT. Freelance designer.

Ryan glances at the motorcycle behind Eva.

RYAN (V.O.)
Though she comes from a humble background, she's more stunning than her profile, and she seems genuinely honest.

Ryan takes Eva's hand.

RYAN
Super, let's get married.

Eva instinctively pulls away.

EVA
(surprised)
Married? Sir, I think you got the wrong person.

She holds out her left hand - it has **a WEDDING RING** on it.

EVA (CONT'D)
I'm already married.

Ryan blinks awkwardly. He glares at David, who flips through the file in his hands.

DAVID
(embarrassed)
Sorry, boss. The marriage partner we prepared for you is indeed someone else.

David hands the **file** to Ryan. Ryan takes a look. David gets on the phone immediately.

Just then, **a luxury car** screeches into the driveway. KEVIN BROWN (30s), dressed in a suit, gets out sloppily.

Eva's face lights up, and she excitedly runs to hug him.

EVA
Honey! How are you doing? I've missed you so much--

Kevin pushes Eva away impatiently.

KEVIN
Get off me!

Eva nearly falls, her bouquet falling to the ground.

Kevin opens the car's passenger door. LINDA CLARK (20s), gaudily dressed, steps out and smugly drapes herself over Kevin.

Eva is disbelieving and furious.

EVA
(loudly)
Kevin, who is she? Why are you with her on our anniversary?

EPISODE 3

3 EXT. CITY HALL ENTRANCE - DAY 3
(EVA, KEVIN, LINDA, RYAN) *

Kevin contemptuously hands **a document** to Eva and she reads it. Her hands tremble with anger - *

CLOSE-UP IT'S A DIVORCE AGREEMENT. *

EVA
(shocked and furious)
A divorce...?

KEVIN
(proudly)
That's right. I'm now President Brown, the man who just signed a ten-million dollar deal with the Jones Group. And you...you're nothing to me. You'd better leave now.

Linda sees Eva's angry and hurt and becomes even more smug and provocative.

LINDA
Sign it! Kevin needs a socialite date like me at the at this occasion. You? Oh no. He'd be a laughing stock because of you.

Eva takes a deep breath, suppressing her rage.

EVA
Kevin, believe or not, all your success over the years, that was me, helping you behind the scenes. I never told you just so you wouldn't feel inferior...I'm Eva Miller, heiress of the Miller family!

Linda sneers.

LINDA
You? The heiress of LA's richest billionaire? Don't make me laugh. You're a starving freelancer. And that Jones contract has nothing to do with you!

Eva charges at Linda.

EVA
(disbelievingly)
I know every single person who handled that deal, and you sure weren't one of them!
(to Kevin, in tears)
If I didn't hide my identity as the billionaire heiress to marry you, you wouldn't even be worthy of meeting me!

Kevin glares at her while Linda cackles.

LINDA
Oh babe, jealousy has made her delusional!

KEVIN
(disdainfully)
Are you trying to make me pity you? Ha, only in your dreams, Eva. Now come on, sign it!

Eva wipes the tears from her face, her expression changing from despair to determination. With anger, she firmly signs her name on the divorce agreement.

EVA
You'll regret, Mr. Brown.

KEVIN
I don't think I will.

Eva shoves the signed agreement back at Kevin. Kevin takes it and looks at it contemptuously.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
Well done!

Kevin turns to Linda, getting down on one knee to propose with **a RING.**

KEVIN (CONT'D)
Linda Clark. Will you marry me?

Linda is delighted.

LINDA
Yes, I will!

Kevin embraces Linda sweetly. Eva's agonized, frozen to the spot. Kevin takes out **a stack of cash** from his pocket.

KEVIN
Why are you still here? Take this and get lost!

Kevin throws the money in Eva's face!

SLOW MODE CASH FLIES EVERYWHERE! *

Eva staggers back, about to fall...but a pair of hands steadies her. It's Ryan! Eva falls into Ryan's arms, their eyes meet.

RYAN
(gently)
Are you alright?

Eva shakes her head and stands up, watching Kevin and Linda leaving with rage in her eyes.

EVA
You guy was saying...you're here for a contract marriage?

Ryan nods.

EVA (CONT'D)
(resolutely)
Let's get married!

Ryan is stunned, captivated by Eva's boldness.

EPISODE 4

4 INT. CITY HALL - DAY 4
(EVA, KEVIN, LINDA, RYAN) *

Ryan and Eva stand **in front of a desk** with an OFFICE STAFF.

RYAN
Are you sure? I'm doing it to keep my parents happy. It'll be a marriage on paper, nothing more.

Eva hands her **ID** to the staff.

EVA
(smiling at Ryan)
I'm sure!

RYAN
What if I'm a deadbeat who can't hold down a job?

Eva pats Ryan's shoulder.

EVA
(confidently)
It's fine, I'll work hard and make money for you.

Ryan looks at Eva's hand, and the two smile at each other.

RYAN (V.O.)
She seems like a good girl. Maybe I could tell her who I really am.

THUD! **Two marriage certificates** are **stamped.**

5 EXT. CITY HALL - DAY 5
(KEVIN, LINDA, RYAN) *

Ryan and Eva walk out of city hall together, as do Kevin and Linda.

Kevin eyes Ryan up and down, his expression disdainful.

KEVIN
(sarcastic)
Wow, Eva, where did you dig up this guy? Out of the bargain bin?

Ryan looks at Kevin.

RYAN
(seriously)
I've led the Jones Group for many years , no one has ever dared to speak to me this way!

Linda laughs scornfully.

LINDA
(disdainfully)
Wait, are you saying that you're the heir to the Jones family? The elusive Ryan Jones who's almost never seen in public?

Ryan looks at everyone solemnly.

RYAN
You are right. I am him.

Linda, Kevin, and Eva are all stunned.

EPISODE 5

6 INT. CITY HALL - DAY 6
(EVA, KEVIN, LINDA, RYAN) *

Linda, Kevin, and Eva are all stunned, looking at Ryan. Suddenly, Linda and Kevin burst out laughing!

KEVIN
(to Linda)
Will the riches take a taxi to the wedding?

Kevin and Linda exchange a smirk.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
(to Ryan)
Come on. Who's gonna believe you're the heir of the Jones?

LINDA
(gestures to Eva)
It's so funny that one of you claims to be the Miller heiress, the other says he's the Jones heir. You both have some nerve!

KEVIN
(viciously)
If the Jones family finds out you're impersonating their president, you won't even have a place to bury yourself!

Ryan steps forward, but Eva holds him back.

EVA
(in a low voice)
You don't have to make things up just to defend me.

RYAN
(gently)
Who says I'm make things up? I am the Jones heir.

Kevin looks at him with disgust.

KEVIN
(sneering)
Whatever. Will find out at the Jones family gala, which is also to celebrate my signing deal. I can't wait to tell the real Mr. Jones all about your idiocy.

RYAN
(coldly)
And I can't wait for you all to see me at the gala and figure out who the real idiots are.

Kevin prods Ryan's shoulder.

KEVIN
We'll see!

Kevin puts his arm around Linda and leaves.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
(loudly)
Honey, let's get you a designer gown. You'll be the belle of the ball.

LINDA
(snuggling Kevin)
My husband's the best.

Eva watches their retreating backs, her expression wistful.

EVA
Cheat me on our anniversary, force a divorce, and then marry another woman without a second thought. Three years of all my love, is it what I got in return?

Ryan hands Eva a black credit card.

RYAN
Don’t worry. Even if it’s a contract marriage, I’ll still take care of you. Here is ten million dollars —treat yourself to whatever you like.

Eva takes it and her eyes widen at the fancy card.

EVA (V.O.)
Ten million?—there's no way he has that kind of money.
(pauses)
But even if it’s just a penny, it’s still more than Kevin ever gave me.

Eva and Ryan walk out together.

EVA
You are so sweet, but I’m the one who should take care of you. I’m a Miller. The Jones family will respect me. I’ll find a way to have Mr. Jones Senior play along with you claiming to be the heir at the banquet.

EVA (CONT’D)
Don’t forget, I’m a Miller.

RYAN
Now who’s the one bluffing? I really am the Jones heir. But with your ex stooping so low, if you want to pretend to be the Miller heiress at the banquet to get back at him, I’ll do whatever it takes to cover for you.

Ryan gets into the taxi, and Eva waves goodbye from outside the car.

RYAN (CONT'D)
I guess I'll see you at the gala...
(disbelieving)
"Miss Miller."

Eva watches the taxi drive off, a resigned smile on her face.

EVA
He seems like a good guy. Why's he pretending to be someone else?

After hanging up, David comes back to the scene and finds everyone already gone.

EPISODE 6

7 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 7
(EVA, HUNTER, MILLER SR., SECURITY GUARD A) *

Subtitle: Three days later

In the hallway, Eva is walking and taking a call from her father, MILLER SR. (70s, only appears as voice).

MILLER SR. (V.O.)
How dare that bastard betray my little girl? I'll send my men to beat some sense into him!

EVA
(interrupting)
Dad, forget it, we're already divorced.

MILLER SR. (V.O.)
Don't worry, my angel. I'll make sure you will find your Mr.s Right.

Eva is taken aback, quickly trying to stop him.

EVA
Dad, there's something I need to tell you, I've already remarried...again...Hello?

But the other side has already hung up. Eva puts down her phone, her expression resigned.

EVA (CONT'D)
I'll find another time to talk to you.

Eva sees a middle-aged man HUNTER GORDON (40-50s) trying to enter, but being roughly blocked by a SECURITY GUARD.

SECURITY GUARD A
An estate Manager? What do you think you are and what do you think this banquet is for? Get out!

Eva sees Hunter being pushed to the ground.

EVA
Is he my father's old friend, Hunter Gordon?

Eva quickly steps forward and helps the middle-aged man up.

EVA (CONT'D)
(urgently)
Mr. Hunter, are you okay?

HUNTER
(joyfully recognizing Eva)
If it isn't the Lady Eva!

Eva frowns, looking at the man and the security guard.

EVA
(puzzled)
What's going on?

The middle-aged man stands up, clutching his behind.

HUNTER
(groaning)
As you know, the three big families in this city are all attending the banquet today. But I'm not a Smith, a Miller, or a Jones..I'm not elite enough to mingle with you lot.

EVA
(unhesitatingly)
This is ridiculous, Mr. Hunter. I'll help you.

Hunter nods in thanks. Eva walks up to Security Guard A.

EVA (CONT'D)
This man is a friend of the Millers.

SECURITY GUARD A
(looking Eva up and down)
And you are...?

EVA
Only the Miller heiress herself. You'll find me on the list, I'm sure.

EPISODE 7

8 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 8 *
(HUNTER, KEVIN, LINDA, SECURITY GUARD A)

Security Guard A is taken aback by Eva's aura.

SECURITY GUARD A
(uncertainly)
You're... the Millers' heiress?

Before he can decide whether to believe it, he sees Kevin with Linda approaching.

SECURITY GUARD A (CONT'D)
(fawning)
Mr. Brown, you're here!

Linda looks at Eva provocatively.

LINDA
(saccharine)
Well, well, if it is not "Miss Miller"! Why aren't you inside?

KEVIN
(smugly)
Maybe the pixie dust from her lies wore off!

Linda and Kevin laugh. Security Guard A looks at Eva and Hunter.

SECURITY GUARD A
(chuckling)
Mr. Brown, give me a second to remove these pests.

He gestures to two more Security Guards who surround Eva and Hunter.

HUNTER
(angrily pointing)
How dare you treat Miss Miller this way!

9 EXT. BANQUET HALL, DRIVEWAY - DAY 9
(BODYGUARDS) *

A luxury car screeches to a halt. Ryan steps out with an imposing presence on the red carpet. *

Bodyguards in black suits standing in two lines bow to him.

BODYGUARDS
Welcome, Mr. Jones!

10 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 10
(EVA, RYAN, SECURITY GUARD A) *

Eva, Hunter and the Security Guards are in a scuffle. Security Guard A raises his baton, and Eva braces for the impact.

SECURITY GUARD A
Let me teach you a lesson!

Ryan rushes in front of Eva, catching the baton! Eva opens her eyes, full of joy and gratitude.

EVA
It's you!

Ryan lands a punch on Security Guard A, knocking him to the ground, his face full of fear.

RYAN
(sternly)
How dare you harm my lady?!

EPISODE 8

11 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 11 *
(DAVID, EVA, KEVIN, RYAN, SECURITY GUARD A, SECURITY GUARD B) *

Eva looks at Ryan, her expression slightly stunned.

EVA
I'm...I'm your...?

Ryan responds to Eva, his expression gentle.

RYAN
My wife, Mrs. Jones. Anything wrong with that? *

Kevin watches the two being affectionate, displeased.

KEVIN
(mockingly)
You're still pretending to be Mr. Jones? This ballroom, heck, the whole hotel belongs to the Jones family.
(to the guards)
Do you know this man?

Security Guard A angrily climbs back up from the ground, exchanging a glance with Security Guard B. They shake their heads repeatedly.

SECURITY GUARD B
Of course not.

SECURITY GUARD A
How can this scumbag pretend to be Jones' heir? If you were him, I'd be the Jones Senior.

RYAN
Do not insult my father.

Ryan grabs Security Guard A by the collar. Kevin separate the two.

KEVIN
(vicious)
You lied to everyone first, poser!
(to Security Guard A)
How can you let me be offended by this prick over and over again?

Security A and B are fooled by Kevin.

SECURITY GUARD A
(resolute)
Of course we can't allow that!

SECURITY GUARD B
Mr. Brown, please go on in. We will take the messy!

Kevin and Linda enter smugly.

KEVIN
When I see Mr. Jones, I'll put in a good word for you!

Ryan suppresses his rage, while Eva's anxious.

Security Guard A and Security Guard B swing their batons, preparing to attack!

Assistant David rushes over, shouting.

DAVID
Stop!

Security Guard A and Security Guard B look at each other.

SECURITY GUARD A
(surprised)
It's the Jones CEO’s personal assistant!

David lands a punch on Security Guard A and kicks Security Guard B to the ground!

DAVID
(sternly)
Have you lost your minds? Do you know who you were going to attack?

The two Security Guards on the ground are shocked.

EPISODE 9

12 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 12
(DAVID, EVA, HUNTER, RYAN, SECURITY GUARD A) *

Security Guard A and Security Guard B get up from the ground.

SECURITY GUARD A
That man was pretending to be Mr. Jones, so we...

David slaps Security Guard A with his left hand and Security Guard B with his right!

DAVID
You two are really stupid and blind.

David turns and bows to Ryan.

DAVID (CONT’D)
My apologies, boss. These two security guards are new here. I’ll dismiss them immediately!

Ryan nods. Eva, Hunter, and the Security Guards are astonished. *

EVA
(disbelievingly)
You really are the Jones' heir.

Hunter excitedly rushes over.

HUNTER
I never thought I'd see the heir of the Jones family, in the flesh!

Ryan looks at Hunter. Hunter, realizing his mistake, makes a shushing motion to promise he'll be quiet about Ryan's identity. Ryan steps forward and takes Eva's hand.

RYAN
I told you I would not lie to you, Eva.

Eva nods, moved. Ryan's gaze sweeps over the prostrate Security Guard A and Security Guard B, then looks at David.

RYAN (CONT'D) *
It's one thing if they mess with * me, but if they dare lay a finger * on Eva, I'll show no mercy. *

DAVID
(puzzled, looking at Eva)
Wait a minute... This is?

Ryan pulls Eva's hand.

RYAN
(smiling)
Allow me introduce my wife, Eva Jones!

EPISODE 10

13 INT. BANQUET HALL, ENTRANCE - DAY 13
(DAVID, EVA, RYAN, SECURITY GUARD A) *

David pushes Security Guard A and Security Guard B forward.

DAVID
(sternly)
Apologize to Mrs. Jones. Now!

Security Guard A and Security Guard B first pause, then react, starting to slap themselves hard while apologizing.

SECURITY GUARD A
(wailing)
I’m sorry! I'm so blind...and despicable! Please forgive me, Mrs. Jones! Please.

Eva waves her hand.

EVA
Alright, that's enough.

David glares at the Security Guards. They flee, stumbling. Hunter takes the opportunity to kick Security Guard A in the butt.

Eva and Ryan exchange a glance, suppressing their laughter. Glancing at his phone, David gives Ryan a meaningful look. Ryan turns to Eva.

RYAN
Please go ahead inside, I'll find you guys shortly.

Eva and Hunter walk into the banquet hall together. After they leave, Ryan looks at David.

RYAN (CONT’D)
What is it?

DAVID
I just got the news. Tonight's guests of honor have arrived!

RYAN
(surprised)
The Millers’ daughter is here?

EPISODE 11

14 INT. BANQUET HALL, SIDE AREA - DAY 14
(IMPORTANT GUEST A, IMPORTANT GUEST B, KEVIN, LINDA) *

Kevin is chatting with two IMPORTANT GUESTS (40s-50s, male).

IMPORTANT GUEST A
(chuckling)
Mr. Brown, you’re looking sharp!

Important Guest B respectfully hands Kevin a business card.

IMPORTANT GUEST B
(fawning)
Congrats on landing that deal with the Jones Group! I hope we can work together soon!

Kevin puffs out his chest proudly. Linda walks over with a glass of wine. The two guests take their leave.

LINDA
Everything is fabulous! I think I saw Leonardo DiCaprio just now!
(coyly)
Kevin, when is your turn to throw a banquet like this?.

KEVIN
(embarrassed)
Uh... I'm still a long way off from the Jones family.

Linda puts down her glass and embraces Kevin.

LINDA
(tenderly)
Don't worry, Kevin. I'm sure you're going to make everything big.

KEVIN
(touched)
Thanks, Linda. You're so sweet.

Linda rests her head on Kevin's shoulder, but secretly winks at the retreating Important Guest A.

Then Linda's smile disappears, and she releases Kevin. Kevin is puzzled and turns to follow her gaze. He sees Eva and Hunter standing at the dessert table.

LINDA
(gritting her teeth)
What the hell? How did she get in here?

15 INT. BANQUET HALL - CONTINUOUS 15
(EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, LINDA) *

Eva and Hunter are enjoying the treats at the dessert table. Not far away, two other GUESTS (any age, gender) are pointing and whispering about them.

GUEST A
Isn't that Hunter Gordon? How did an estate manager like him get in?

GUEST B
Maybe his date's a big shot.

GUEST A
(gasps)
No way, could she be one of the guests of honor?

Linda and Kevin stride up to Eva and confront her.

LINDA
(raising her voice)
Guest of honor? She’s nothing!

Eva glances at the two, continuing to finish the last bite of her dessert, gracefully accepting the handkerchief Hunter offers her to wipe her hands.

EVA
I'm nothing but the guest of honor tonight.

The two Guests nearby are shocked by her words.

GUEST A
(stunned)
Oh my goodness, don't tell me... she's Miss Miller!

EPISODE 12

16 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 16
(EVA, HUNTER, KEVIN, LEO, LINDA) *

Linda sneers, and Kevin's expression is sinister.

KEVIN (V.O.)
Pathetic. She must be here to get me back!

Kevin steps up to Eva.

KEVIN
Eva, I know you feel bad, But we're done. Don’t be a stalker.

Eva is full of disgust.

EVA
Stalk you? You're just trash I should have thrown away long ago.

Kevin is infuriated.

KEVIN
(angrily)
You...!

Eva then looks at Linda.

EVA
(scornfully)
And you're just the woman who picked up my trash. I truly pity you.

Linda rushes forward to slap Eva but Hunter steps forward, shielding Eva.

HUNTER
(angrily)
How dare you lay a hand on the guest of honor?

Linda shakes off Hunter.

LINDA
(viciously)
There's no place for you to talk. Get out of my way!

In the scuffle, the banquet hall doors open, and a tall, burly figure in all black enters, making an imposing impression - this is LEO CLARK (40-50s).

LEO
(sternly)
What's going on here?

EPISODE 13

17 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 17
(EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, HUNTER, KEVIN, LEO, LINDA, RYAN)

Leo walks forward, separating Hunter and Linda. The Guests immediately become excited.

GUEST A
That's Leo Clark, the head of the Jones's private security!

GUEST B
I’m sure he's not someone you want to cross!

Linda secretly smiles, leaning in to whisper in Leo's ear.

LINDA
(in a low voice)
Dad, she's the bitch who stole my man!

LEO
(gritting his teeth)
Upset my baby girl? I won't let you get away with this!

Leo turns to Hunter and Eva as Bodyguards arrive.

LEO (CONT’D)
(sternly, to guards)
Lock ‘em up, boys.

Hunter shields Eva.

HUNTER
(angrily)
You're locking us up? On what grounds?

Linda is smug.

LINDA
You're trespassing at a private event! You have no invitation!

Guest B points at Eva and Hunter.

GUEST B
They snuck in here? How reckless! Got a death wish?

Kevin and Linda look pleased with themselves. Leo waves his hand imperiously.

LEO
Take them!

Leo's gaze sweeps over the hesitating black-suited Bodyguards. Hunter panics. Eva is calm.

EVA
(out loud)
Wait!

The Bodyguards are startled. They exchange looks amongst each other.

EVA (CONT'D)
Although I don't have an invitation, I AM the guest of honor here today. Whoever dare lay hands on me, Mr. Jones will not let you off the hook!

LEO
Only the top three family's heiress Ms. Miller can claim to be the guest of honor in front of the Jones. A low-rung like you can't possibly be worthy!

KEVIN
One second you're the daughter of the biggest family, and now you claim to be the guest of honor. She must be out of her mind!

Linda shakes Leo on his arm.

LINDA
Daddy, kick this lunatic out right now!

LEO
What are you all still waiting for? Get them!

The Bodyguards pounce toward Eva aggressively. Hunter shields Eva again.

HUNTER
Get behind me, Lady Eva!

Just then, the banquet hall doors open again.

RYAN (O.S.)
Stand down, right now!

Ryan, in a gorgeous suit, strides into the room.

EPISODE 14

18 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 18
(EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, HUNTER, KEVIN, LEO, LINDA, RYAN)

Leo immediately gets frightened.

LEO (V.O.)
(trembling)
Mr. Jones!

Ryan walks up to Hunter.

RYAN
Thank you for looking after Mrs. Jones. Tell you what, I've got a 20-million dollar project coming up. Why don't you go find my assistant and talk it out?

Hunter is delighted.

HUNTER
(muttering)
Am I dreaming? A 20 million dollar deal... I'd be wealthy beyond my wildest imagination!

Eva smiles and urges him on.

EVA
The least I can do for you. *

HUNTER
(excitedly)
Thank you, Lady Eva. Thank you, Mr. Jones!!

Hunter thanks them and happily runs off. Eva examines Ryan, noticing he’s changed his suit.

EVA
A change of clothes for greeting the guest of honor?

RYAN
(seriously)
The Miller family controls all the wealth in Los Angeles. Naturally, I must treat this meeting with the utmost importance.
(observes Eva)
Jealous?

Eva blinks, smiles to herself.

EVA (V.O.)
How would I be jealous of myself.

Ryan catches Eva's expression and lowers his head with a grin. Kevin spots the flirtation between them and becomes furious.

KEVIN
Eva, is bringing your petty self here not enough, that you have to drag another with you?

Leo panics and gestures Kevin to shut up. Kevin doesn't see it and continues to provoke.

Guest A and B are shocked.

GUEST A
Has Mr. Brown lost his mind? How can he call Mr. Jones petty?

GUEST B
He's not at the level where he can recognize Mr. Jones. Just so you wait for the drama.

Linda walks up to Ryan, looking him up and down.

LINDA
If you don't want a beating, there's a way out—just apologize and give yourself a few slaps. Maybe then I'll let you off.

GUEST B sucks in a breath.

GUEST B
How dare she talk to Mr. Jones like this?!

Ryan sneers.

RYAN
And what if I don't?

Leo frantically gestures to Linda, but she pushes him away.

LINDA
Suit yourself.
(to guards)
Get him!

The Bodyguards lunge towards Ryan and Eva. Leo hurries to stop them.

LEO
Stop right now, you idiots!

Linda laughs smugly. Kevin continues to shout.

KEVIN
Have all the fun you want. Medical fees are on me.

Leo rushes forward, kicking Kevin to the ground!

LEO
(urgently)
I said stop!

Kevin lies on the ground, shocked. Linda is confused.

LINDA
(stomping her foot)
Dad!

Leo slaps his daughter hard across the face.

LEO
(heartbroken)
I don’t have a fool for a daughter like you! You two—hurry up, apologize to Mr. Jones immediately!

Linda and Kevin are stunned.

EPISODE 15

19 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 19
(DAVID, EVA, GUEST A, KEVIN, LEO, LINDA, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Leo slaps each of Bodyguard.

LEO
Idiots! Idiots! Idiots! How could you not recognize your young master!

Kevin lies on the ground, Linda is terrified.

LINDA
He... he really is the Jones’s son?

KEVIN
(disbelievingly)
Eva was my burden. How could she somehow managed to worm her way into the top three empire families?

Ryan looks at Eva, who is lost in thought.

RYAN
Are you alright?

EVA
(shaking her head)
I'm fine, just can’t believe I married this guy and bent over backwards to help him all these years...especially that ten million deal.

Kevin crawls over, hugging Ryan's leg and begging for forgiveness.

KEVIN
(crying)
Please forgive me, Mr. Jones. You can do whatever you want to me. Beat me! Scold me! But keep our contract!

RYAN
(sneering)
Ah, thanks for reminding me. David?

David steps forward.

DAVID
Yes, boss.

RYAN
(decisively)
Cancel all our dealings with the Brown Company, immediately.

Kevin collapses in despair, his expression hopeless!

Ryan's gaze sweeps over all the guests.

RYAN (CONT’D)
Attention! Anyone who dares to partner with Mr. Kevin Brown is making an enemy of the entire Jones family.

The observing GUEST A and GUEST B shake their heads.

GUEST A
This man is doomed!

Kevin confronts Linda and grabs her.

KEVIN
(urgently)
Linda, my dear! You must have a way to save me!

Linda avoids him disdainfully and guiltily.

LINDA
(hisses)
Let go of me! It’s none of my business!

Two black-suited men come forward, grab Kevin, and expel him from the banquet hall.

Ryan takes Eva's hand and walks up to the podium.

RYAN
Tonight, I have an important announcement to make.

Ryan looks at Eva.

RYAN (CONT’D)
I'm married.

The guests below erupt, whispering and discussing.

RYAN (CONT’D)
This is my wife, Eva Jones! From now on, she'll join me at the helm of Jones Group.

Ryan looks at Eva with tenderness. Eva nods, smiling.

The door opens, and an extravagantly-dressed man with a cunning expression, strides in. This is THOMPSON JONES, Ryan's brother.

THOMPSON
Objection!

Everyone turns towards him, surprised.

EPISODE 16

20 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 20

Thompson pulls Ryan down from the podium. (ANNA, GUEST A, GUEST B, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

THOMPSON
(angrily)
Ryan, you can’t just marry a woman off the street!

Ryan shakes off Thompson's hand.

RYAN
First, I will not tolerate any disrespect toward Eva. Second, my marriage is my decision to make.

THOMPSON
(angrily)
As your brother, I’m on behalf of our entire family. Don’t forget you're already engaged to the heiress of the Smith family!

The Guests below start murmuring.

GUEST A
Out of the three richest families in the city, the Smiths rank second.

Eva looks at Ryan in surprise. Ryan furrows his brow, lost in recollection.

RYAN
(seriously)
I never agreed to an engagement with Miss Smith.

Thompson is urgent.

THOMPSON
But Miss Smith has already set her sights on you as her fiancé! While the Smith family may not match the wealth of the Millers, you know we can’t afford to offend the Smiths!

The guests start murmuring again.

GUEST B
The Smiths’ daughter is a feisty one. If Mr. Jones backs out now, she'll stop at nothing to get revenge.

Ryan takes Eva's hand.

RYAN
(gently)
I’m not marrying anyone else. Eva is the only one for me.

Eva looks at Ryan, her eyes filled with gratitude and relief, but Thompson breaks them apart.

THOMPSON
(furious)
Are you really going to put the entire family at risk for a nobody like her?

Ryan stares at Thompson, not backing down.

RYAN
I'm next in line to lead our family. You think I don't know what I'm doing?

The two are in a standoff.

ANNA (O.S.)
And what a leader you've turned out to be. How dare you not take me, Anna Smith, seriously!

The banquet hall doors open, and a meticulously dressed, heavily made-up woman, ANNA SMITH (20s, domineering), strides in with a commanding presence.

EPISODE 17

21 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 21
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, LINDA, RYAN) *

Striding down the aisle, an imposing Anna approaches.

GUEST A
(excited)
She's here! Miss Anna from the Smith family!

LINDA
(chuckling)
Eva's in big trouble now!

Anna reaches Eva, scrutinizing her up and down.

ANNA
(contemptuously)
So you're the bitch who stole my man?

Eva glances at her, shaking her head, indifferent.

EVA (V.O.)
Compared to my Millers, the Smith is nothing more than ants.

Anna, infuriated by Eva's indifference, raises her hand.

ANNA
Hey, I'm talking to you!

Eva closes her eyes, but Ryan catches Anna's slap!

RYAN
(coldly)
You should mind your manners, Miss. I never agreed to marry you.

Anna withdraws her hand.

ANNA
(arrogantly)
I'll marry whoever if I want. Divorce this woman, right now!

Ryan stares into Anna's eyes.

RYAN
(firmly)
You dream it.

The Guests whisper and point. Anna's humiliated, angry.

ANNA
(sneering)
You married this random woman just to get out of our engagement,
(looking at Eva)
And you married Ryan for his money, didn't you?!

Eva chuckles and shakes her head. Anna takes out a black card and throws it at Eva.

ANNA (CONT'D)
There's 10 million dollars in here. More money than you could ever earn in your lifetime! Take it and leave NY for good! *

The guests look at Eva with anticipation. Eva bends down and picks up the black card.

GUEST A
(shaking head)
Looks like she got an offer she couldn't refuse.

Ryan's about to object, but Eva ruthlessly snaps the card in half in front of everyone.

ANNA
(screaming)
That was 10 million dollars! How dare you...!

Eva elegantly tosses the shards at Anna.

EVA
(smiling)
Ten million? Even a hundred million, we Millers can dust it off without a second thought!

EPISODE 18

22 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 22 *
(ANNA, DOOR GUARD, EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B)

The Guests point at Eva and murmur.

GUEST A
(shocked)
She said she's a Miller!

GUEST B
That's impossible.

Anna scrutinizes Eva, disdainful.

ANNA
How do you expect us to believe you?

Guest A nods along.

GUEST A
Yeah, a Miller wouldn't come to the gala without a proper gift.

Eva slaps her forehead, frustrated.

EVA (V.O.)
Dammit. My father was supposed to send the gift ahead.

Anna looks smug.

ANNA
(laughing)
Looks like your charade's falling apart, you fake!

Just then, the voice of a DOOR GUARD is heard.

DOOR GUARD (V.O.)
Presenting the esteemed head of the Jones family, Mr. Albert Jones.

The banquet hall doors open, and JONES SR. strides in with an imposing presence. A dramatic close-up.

EPISODE 19

23 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 23
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST B, JONES SR., LINDA, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Jones Sr. walks to the front, his expression serious. Thompson steps forward to support him.

THOMPSON
Father, about what just happened...

JONES SR.
I've been briefed, thank you very much.
(pausing, his gaze sweeping over everyone)
This is a party, everyone should have a good time. Who's spoiling it?

Anna points at Eva.

ANNA
This woman! She’s ruined the partnership between the Smiths and the Jones, and she's impersonating the Millers' daughter!

Jones Sr. is startled. He doesn’t recognize Eva.

JONES SR.
(angrily to Eva)
I invited Miss Miller personally today, for our first meeting face to face. How dare you interfere!

Eva hurries to explain.

EVA
Mr. Jones, I am Miss Miller...

Before Eva can finish, Ryan quickly covers her mouth.

RYAN
(in a low voice)
There's no need to put on an act in front of my father—it'll only upset him!

Eva reluctantly swallows the truth. A servant whispers something to Anna, and she nods, stepping forward.

ANNA
Mr. Jones, don't let this charlatan ruin the party. Now it’s present time for you.

Everyone turns to look at Anna.

ANNA (CONT’D)
(smugly)
Bring it in!

Five SERVANTS carry in cloth-covered trays (or cloches) and place them before the crowd.

With a glance from Anna, the servants unveil the trays, revealing EXPENSIVE JEWELRY - earrings, a necklace, bracelets, and rings, all made with the largest sapphires.

ANNA (CONT’D)
(looking at Jones Sr.)
Mr. Jones, I know you're an avid jewel collector. The Smith family has curated the world's largest sapphires for you, worth billions of dollars.

The guests gasp in awe, and Jones Sr. nods excitedly. Anna turns to Eva, smug.

ANNA (CONT'D)
And you, the daughter of the wealthiest family in the city, couldn't bring anything even close to this.

Eva steps forward for a closer look at the gems.

EVA
(sneering)
I really couldn't!

All the people present wear mocking expressions.

GUEST B
(clicking his tongue)
Ooh, she's exposed now.

LINDA
(smugly)
That bitch is about to get smoked out.

Eva remains calm. She looks at everyone and raises her voice.

EVA
I couldn't, because the Millers only buy real gems, not knock-offs like these.

Anna looks uneasy, while Ryan and Jones Sr. are shocked.

EPISODE 20

24 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 24
(ANNA, BODYGUARD, EVA, GUEST A, JONES SR., MIKE, RYAN, THOMPSON) * *

Anna is furious yet uneasy.

ANNA
How dare you accuse me of buying knock-offs??

Eva smiles.

EVA
The world's largest sapphire has been in my family for years - the crown jewel of the Millers!

The Guests are in an uproar. Jones Sr. furrows his brow. Anna is enraged.

ANNA
Your Miller family? How could you even speak those words?!

THOMPSON
(disdainfully)
I'd love to know what Mike Sullivan would have to say about this.

As he speaks, the bodyguard's voice is heard again.

BODYGUARD (O.S.)
Presenting the Chief of Staff of the Miller family, Mike Sullivan.

The banquet hall doors open, and Mike strides in, followed by two SERVANTS carrying a box. The guests all bow to Mike.

MIKE
Miss Miller has prepared an exquisite gift for the jewel collector, Albert Jones-the world's largest sapphire.

Jones Sr. walks up and opens the box. CLOSE-UP: Inside is a huge, transparent, cushion-cut blue sapphire.

JONES SR.
It's so beautiful! I've seen photos before, but this...

Thompson leans in, amazed.

THOMPSON
Oh my God, I've never seen a sapphire this big and beautiful!

Eva smiles.

EVA
Now this is the real deal, wouldn't you agree?

Anna is in disbelief.

ANNA
How is it possible?!

Guest A laughs mockingly.

GUEST A
(scornful)
Have to say, Miss Smith's jewels look like a toy in comparison.

Anna’s furious. Mike and Eva exchange a look, both stifling laughter.

Mike's phone VIBRATES, and he steps out of the banquet hall to take the call.

Ryan steps forward and takes Eva's hand.

RYAN
Eva, be honest with me, are you really the Millers' daughter?

EPISODE 21

25 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 25
(ANNA, EVA, RYAN, SERVANT A, THOMPSON) *

Eva looks earnestly into Ryan's eyes.

EVA
I really am. If you don’t believe me, just ask Mike --

Eva, Ryan, and Anna all turn, but Mike is gone.

EVA (CONT’D)
(surprised)
Huh, he was just here!

Anna regains her composure.

ANNA
(sternly)
So you’re fake any way. Guards, throw her out immediately!

3 Guards approach to grab Eva, but Ryan blocks them! *

RYAN
(rebuking)
Stand down.

The Security Guards exchange glances and obey. Anna is furious.

ANNA
Ryan, how could you still protect this woman!

Ryan shields Eva.

RYAN
(firmly)
I vowed to marry this woman for better for worse, for richer for poorer. I will not divorce her!

Thompson steps forward to try to pull Ryan away.

THOMPSON
(angrily) *
Have you lost your mind?! *

Ryan shakes off Thompson and looks at Anna.

RYAN
(resolute)
I'll pay you whatever you want, I'll compensate you for the card she snapped. But there's no way to give up Eva and marry you!

Eva looks at Ryan, her eyes full of gratitude.

EVA (V.O.)
Our marriage is just a contract, yet he's so devoted... what a man.

Anna lets out a furious scream, pointing at Ryan and Eva.

ANNA
(angrily)
Fine! You two... I'm not letting you get away with this!

After Anna storms out of the banquet hall, SERVANT A pulls an invitation from his pocket.

SERVANT A
Mr. Jones, there's another gift especially for you, from Miss Miller.

Eva looks puzzled.

EVA
(V.O.)
I don't remember arranging any other gifts.

Ryan steps forward and takes the invitation, opening it. A close-up shows the large text: "Dear Mr.Ryan Jones, You are invited to the Lovers' Ball" (or similar).

SERVANT A
Miss Miller will be holding a Lovers' Ball in three days. Elites from the entire city are invited. At the end of the Ball, she will select a husband.

Eva and Ryan are shocked, while Jones Sr.is overjoyed!

EPISODE 22

27 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 27
(EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, JONES SR., LINDA, RYAN) *

Eva sighs, resigned.

EVA (V.O.)
My father told me on the phone that he'd find me a husband from one of the three great families. Looks like he really suit the action to the word!

Ryan notices Eva's expression and, thinking she's upset, immediately comforts her.

RYAN
(resolute)
Don't worry, Eva. No matter whose ball this is, I won't go. I'm yours.

EVA *
(moved, holding back) *
Ryan, I really am the M-- *

Jones Sr. approaches, interrupting.

JONES SR.
Ryan, if you don't divorce this woman and attend that ball, you can forget about your inheritance!

GUEST A and B click their tongues.

GUEST A
When Miss Smith was pushing young Jones to marry her, Jones Sr.
(MORE)

GUEST A (CONT'D)
stayed away. But now Miss Miller has set her sights on his son, he's immediately forcing a divorce!

GUEST B
He really knows what he's doing.

Linda walks up smugly.

LINDA
Eva, now you're done for. What can you do against Miss Miller? She'll crush you like a cockroach!

EPISODE 23

28 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 28
(EVA, JONES SR., RYAN) *

Ryan takes Eva's hand and walks up to Jones Sr..

RYAN
Father, I am a man of honor and a CEO. Even if I were not married, I would not attend a Lovers' Ball like this. *

Seeing Ryan's resolute expression, Eva is touched.

EVA (V.O.) *
I supported Kevin for three years. *
He abandoned me in return. Yet this *
man who came out of the blue, *
chooses me with such determination *
even facing the insurmountable *
wealth. *

Jones Sr. sighs.

JONES SR.
Ryan, you have irreparably offended the Smith family today. Should we also forfeit the support of the Miller family? I fear we may very well see the downfall of the Jones family!

Ryan is confident.

RYAN
Father, I am already orchestrating a monumental project with a 20-million dollars investment. The bidding begins the day after tomorrow. If I can secure this venture, the Jones family will surpass the Smiths in strength. We need not fear any retaliation from them!

JONES SR.
But what if the Smiths emerge victorious in this bidding war? What then becomes of the Jones family? The very future of our house hangs on a thread!

Ryan is at a loss for words. He looks at Eva.

EVA
(gently)
Ryan, I believe you should attend Miss Miller's Lovers' Ball.

Ryan is surprised.

RYAN
Eva, are you sure?

Eva smiles and shakes her head. Ryan gratefully embraces her.

RYAN (CONT'D)
Thank you for understanding.

Eva gently pats Ryan's back.

EVA (V.O.)
(smiling)
Soon, you'll know who I really am.

EPISODE 24

30 INT. RYAN'S VILLA, HALLWAY - DAY 30

(David, Ryan, Eva)

SUPER: Ryan's Villa (or Mansion)

David puts Eva's suitcase down at the door. Following Ryan, and Eva.

RYAN
Anna Smith's got it out for you now. Move in here, so I can ensure you're properly protected.

DAVID
Mrs. Jones, this is the room for you. If you need anything, just let m,...

Ryan glares at David. David stutters.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Let... Mr. Jones know, haha.

David sneaks away. Eva suppresses her laughter. Ryan cracks up too.

Ryan pushes the door open, with Eva's suitcase in the other hand. Eva walks in to a king-size bed.

EVA
(blushing)
Is this my room... or our room?

Ryan smiles and puts her suitcase down...then he pins Eva to the wall.

RYAN
(gentle smile)
You're my lawfully wedded wife. What do you think?

EVA
(blushing even more)
But... it's just a contract, right?

Ryan laughs, letting Eva go.

RYAN
So of course it's your room.

Eva's relieved, then realizes Ryan was tricking her. Mad, she whacks him in the chest. Ryan laughs and evades her, knocking over the suitcase.

The suitcase opens, revealing DRAWINGS inside - they are all JEWELRY DESIGNS. Eva crouches down to tidy the drawings, and Ryan helps.

RYAN (CONT'D)
(picking up a design)
Your jewelry designs are quite impressive.

EVA
(faux humble)
Thanks. I have a great passion for it, and you know, I've won a few awards.

RYAN
The Jones Group's design department is recruiting a Design Director, with a monthly salary of 120k. I think you should give it a try.

Eva blinks, contemplating.

EVA (V.O.)
I'm the Muse Design Awards winner, my designs have sold for millions. This position offers is beneath my worth... But I've been rather bored lately... *

Eva finally agrees.

EVA
I think I will try. Thanks, Ryan.

Suddenly, Eva's phone rings. It's her father. She stands up to answer.

EVA (CONT'D)
Hi, Dad. what's up? ...This afternoon? ...Actually, I'm heading to the Jones Group's design office.

MILLER SR. (V.O.)
Ok. I shall make sure the Jones family to give my precious daughter the warmest reception!

Eva wants to stop him, but he HANGS UP. She's frustrated.

31 INT. JONES GROUP, ENTRANCE - DAY (MANAGER) 31 *

A group of 7-8 DESIGNERS and JANITORS bustle about, tidying the area.

The MANAGER, using a rolled-up paper as a megaphone, shouts.

MANAGER
(excited)
Hurry up!
(MORE)

MANAGER (CONT'D)
The Miller heiress will pay a visit this afternoon. Your jobs are on the line for this!

EPISODE 25

32 INT. JONES GROUP, ENTRANCE - DAY 32
(ASSISTANT, EVA, MANAGER) *

A distance away - Eva wears a baggy T-shirt and jeans, carrying a GEMSTONE RING.

Eva's ASSISTANT (20s) carries a roll of drawings, and they chat as they walk.

ASSISTANT
(appraising Eva)
Miss Jones, it's your first day as Design Director, and yet you've chosen such a simple outfit.

EVA
(nonchalant)
Work, after all, is about simplicity and comfort.

Eva points to a bench.

EVA (CONT'D)
Come, sit.

Eva and the Assistant sit on the bench. Eva holds the ring.

EVA (CONT'D)
Look, the gem's setting here requires careful attention to the angle. Precision is crucial for the perfect alignment.

ASSISTANT
(writing down)
Ok, I got it.

As the Assistant nods, a grating voice interrupts them.

MANAGER (O.S.)
(ferocious)
Sloppy! You'll embarrass me in front of Miss Miller. You're fired!

Eva looks turns around and sees the MANAGER (30s) is kicking a Janitor in the hallway.

EVA
(frowning)
Who is that?

ASSISTANT
He’s the department head and one of your subordinates. It’s rumored he’s a distant cousin of the Jones family, having risen through nepotism. He apparently knows nothing about design.

Eva is furious.

EVA
(serious)
Looks like this department needs an overhaul!

The Manager notices Eva and the Assistant. He strides over aggressively.

MANAGER
What are you doing loitering around on the stairs? The Miller heiress is on her way!

The Assistant stands up, smiling apologetically.

ASSISTANT
Manager, she's...

The Manager shoves the Assistant to the ground.

MANAGER
(to Eva)
Get out of here, now!

Eva remains seated, looking at the Manager with a cold smile.

EVA
(disdainfully)
Do you even know who I am?

EPISODE 26

33 INT. JONES GROUP, ENTRANCE - DAY 33
(ASSISTANT, EVA, MANAGER) *

The Manager looks Eva up and down.

MANAGER
What? You wanna claim you’re a Miller sister or something? You’re just a cheap labor! *

Eva is still seated, and the Assistant hurries forward.

ASSISTANT
(urgently)
Sir, she's the new design director, your superior!

The Manager slaps the Assistant across the face.

MANAGER
Don’t talk back to me, girl! Who does this trash think she is, trying to order me around?

Eva stands up to support the Assistant.

EVA
(angrily)
I don't need someone like you on my team. You're fired!

The Manager laughs.

MANAGER
Fire me? I heard the new director is one of the best designers in the world. And you, a nobody, dare to impersonate her?

ASSISTANT
(urgently)
It’s really her!

The Assistant picks up the drawings on the ground and hands them to the Manager.

ASSISTANT (CONT’D)
Look, these are her designs.

The Manager takes them, examining them skeptically.

EVA
(mockingly)
You're holding them upside down.

The Manager, enraged, throws the drawings to the ground. The Assistant quickly crouches down to pick them up.

ASSISTANT
Don’t throw these around! They’re for a twenty-million dollar project.

The Manager viciously stomps on the Assistant's hand as she tries to pick up the drawings.

MANAGER
Oh yeah? I’m not just ditching it, I’ll stomp on it too. What are you going to do about it?

Eva’s reached her limit, she punches the Manager's face!

EVA
(furious)
Enough!

EPISODE 27

34 INT. JONES GROUP, ENTRANCE - DAY 34
(MANAGER) *

Punched, the Manager spits out a gob of blood.

MANAGER
(viciously)
Damn it, you've got some nerve! I'll teach you what happens when you mess with the wrong person. Guards!

4-5 SECURITY GUARDS rush over and grab Eva's arms. The Assistant tries to protect her but is kicked to the ground.

The Manager, with a lecherous grin, signals the guards to push Eva into his office.

35 INT. JONES GROUP, OFFICE - DAY 35
(MANAGER, THOMPSON) *

The Security Guards force Eva to kneel on the ground.

MANAGER
(lustfully)
You’ve got a pretty face for a street rat. I’ll let you go after I have some fun.

The Manager smiles lewdly and starts to unbuckle his buttons. *

THOMPSON (O.S.)
(sternly)
What the hell are you doing?

Thompson barges in and slaps the Manager hard across the face.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
Assaulting Mrs. Jones, have you gone insane?

MANAGER
(shocked)
Mrs. Jones? She's...

Thompson wipes his hand nonchalantly.

THOMPSON
She's Ryan's new wife.

The Manager fearfully bows and apologizes to Eva.

MANAGER
So sorry, ma'am, please forgive me, please forgive me!

EPISODE 28

36 INT. JONES GROUP, OFFICE - DAY 36
(ASSISTANT, EVA, MANAGER, THOMPSON) *

Eva looks at him with disdain. Thompson glances at her.

THOMPSON
You've barely been a Jones for a week, you've promoted to Director. But I wonder, once you're divorced, will all this still be yours to keep?

Hearing this, the Manager straightens up and is arrogant again.

MANAGER
Hah! So you're just a soon-to-be discarded ex of the Jones CEO? You made me grovel for nothing.

He approaches to hit her. He throws a punch at her, but Eva catches his fist and throws it aside. He staggers back, yelling. Eva remains calm and collected.

EVA
(to Thompson)
I’m not here just because I’m a Jones. I’m more than qualified to lead this team.

The Assistant seizes the opportunity to pick up the drawings on the ground and hand them to Thompson.

ASSISTANT
It's true, look at these designs. She’s the best!

Thompson takes the drawings, his expression gradually turning to one of surprise as he looks at them.

THOMPSON (V.O.)
This style... it’s so familiar.

Thompson puts down the drawings and stares at Eva intently.

THOMPSON
These are "Miss E"’s designs!

The Manager and Assistant are shocked.

MANAGER
(fearfully)
The renowned Miss E? Whose design is rumored to be worth three hundred million? You, of all people...?

EPISODE 29

37 INT. JONES GROUP, OFFICE - DAY 37
(EVA, LINDA, MANAGER, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Eva steps forward, smiling.

EVA
I am Miss E herself!

Thompson pauses for a second, then looks up at her.

THOMPSON
(scoffing)
Lier. I've seen Miss E in person. She doesn't look a thing like you!

MANAGER
(cocky)
So she’s an imposter!

The Security Guards chuckle along with the Manager. Eva is slightly startled.

EVA (V.O.)
(pondering)
Could someone be impersonating me?
(regretfully)
I shouldn't have worn a mask when I accepted the award back then!

Thompson waves a dismissive hand.

THOMPSON
You’re a pathological liar. Guards, get her out of here!

The Manager lunges at Eva aggressively, and when the assistant tries to stop him, he kicks her away.

The Manager pins Eva down, and she struggles fiercely. Eva bites the Manager's hand, breaking free.

The Manager slaps Eva hard across the face in retaliation. A bloody mark appears on Eva's face.

MANAGER
(viciously)
Bitch, you bit me? You’ll pay for it!

Just then Ryan arrives, punching the Manager.

RYAN
(rebuking)
We’ll see who’s paying for it.

The freed Eva also takes the opportunity to slap Thompson hard, sending him spinning and screaming.

EPISODE 30

38 INT. JONES GROUP, OFFICE - DAY 38
(EVA, LINDA, MANAGER, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Ryan tosses the unconscious Manager to the ground and walks towards Thompson.

RYAN
Thompson, are you going to stand by while Eva is bullied? Do you not acknowledge the authority of your CEO? Or do I mean nothing to you?

THOMPSON
(clutching face, furious)
She’s making some trouble here. She’s impersonating Miss E.

EVA
(angrily)
I am Miss E, I never impersonated anyone.

Ryan looks at Eva, about to say something, when he notices the bloody mark on her face.

RYAN
Who did this?

The unconscious Manager on the ground immediately opens his eyes and scrambles up, bowing and apologizing to Eva.

MANAGER
I’m sorry, I deserve to die, please forgive me, ma’am.

EVA
(expressionless)
You never deserved your position in the first place. You're fired!
(looking at the assistant)
From now on, you're the manager.

The Assistant is overjoyed. The Manager looks at Ryan.

MANAGER
(tearfully)
President, please...

Ryan gently puts his arm around Eva's shoulder.

RYAN
(curt)
We’ll do as my wife has instructed.

The Manager collapses to the ground in despair. The Security Guards drag him away, and the Assistant happily kicks him in the ass as he passes her by.

Eva secretly smiles at the sight, but it quickly fades.

LINDA (O.S.)
Didn't expect to see you again!

Linda, wearing sunglasses, struts over to them seductively.

THOMPSON
(suddenly brightening)
It's her! The best designer in the city, Miss E!

Eva, Ryan, and the Assistant are shocked.

EPISODE 31

39 INT. JONES GROUP, OFFICE - DAY 39 *
(ASSISTANT, EVA, LINDA, RYAN) *

Linda takes off her sunglasses, looking at everyone.

LINDA
Yes, it's me, I'm Miss E!

EVA
(angrily) *
No, you're not. *

Linda calmly takes a stack of drawings from her bag.

LINDA
Am I? I've got all my designs right here.

The Assistant takes the drawings and everyone gathers around to look.

ASSISTANT
(disbelieving, embarrassed)
She really is Miss E...

Eva clenches her fists.

EVA (V.O.)
(furious)
Impossible. These drafts are clearly mine...
(suddenly realizing)
Kevin and Linda must have stolen these drafts from my home! *

Eva looks frustrated. *

LINDA
(peers at Eva)
The plain Jane would never be the princess. Stop making us laugh.
(with disgust)
Let’s go, Thompson. I’m fed up with these lowlives.

Thompson smirks cheekily. Linda hooks his arm and leaves with him.

EVA
Wait! I really am--

Ryan shushes Eva, gently brushing her hair back.

RYAN
Eva, whether you're an heiress or an ordinary girl, a famous designer or a rookie, I won't leave you. I wish you were more comfortable being yourself.

Eva looks resigned.

EVA (V.O.)
It’s okay. Even if he doesn’t believe me now... he’ll have to at the Lovers’ Ball.

Ryan strokes Eva’s hair.

RYAN
By the way... I need you to do me a favor.

Eva’s stunned.

EPISODE 32

41 EXT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE - DAY 41
(EVA, RYAN)

SUPER: Three hours later.

The luxury car brakes abruptly and pulls over. Ryan and Eva get out of the luxury car. Eva looks at the "MILLERS" sign, reflecting.

EVA (V.O.)
I can’t believe the favor was going shopping. At my own family's department store.

Suddenly, Ryan's phone RINGS. He answers, and frowns.

RYAN
(gravely)
What?! I'll be right there!

Ryan hangs up the phone and looks at Eva.

RYAN (CONT’D)
I'm sorry, there's something in the company...

EVA
(understandingly nodding)
It’s fine. You go ahead.

Ryan hands Eva a VIC Card. *

RYAN
(relieved)
That card has no limit. Buy whatever you like.

CLOSE-UP: showing the “VIC” on the credit card. *

Watching Ryan leave, Eva holds up the VIC card, then holds up a VERY VIC CARD (VVIC) she already had in her other hand. * *

EVA (V.O.)
I’m the heiress of the Miller family and the VVIC card holder. *
Let me save Ryan a few bucks today!

42 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 42
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA) *

Eva walks into a clothing store, seeing a beautiful dress and can't resist touching it.

Two female store EMPLOYEES A and B notice Eva’s plain outfit and walks over.

EMPLOYEE A
(disdainfully)
Don’t touch what you can’t afford!

Eva is startled, turning to face them.

EVA
(frowning)
Are you talking to me?

EPISODE 33

43 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 43
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA, STORE MANAGER) *

Employee A, chewing gum, rolls her eyes and snatches the dress from Eva's hand.

EMPLOYEE A
(disdainful)
Who else would she be talking to?
You're the one waltzing in here
dressed all thrift-store chic.

EVA
(offended) *
This shirt is made of high-tech *
fabric, worth more than a hundred *
thousand dollars. My father *
designed it with Mr. Lagerfeld it *
for me as a singular print. *

Employee A lets out a mocking laugh.

EMPLOYEE A
A hundred-thousand dollar T-shirt? *
You expect me to believe that?

EVA
(smiling)
Believe whatever you want. Now,
leave me in peace.

Eva looks at another dress. Employee A charges over and shoves Eva to the ground.

EMPLOYEE A
This is an haute-couture designer
store! Broke ass like you don't
belong here!

Eva falls to the ground, pained. Employee B bends over Eva and points accusingly at her.

EMPLOYEE A (CONT'D)
(viciously)
Get out of here, or I'll call
security to throw you out!

STORE MANAGER (O.S.)
Jesus, what's with all this racket!

The STORE MANAGER (male, flamboyant) rushes in and announces:

STORE MANAGER (CONT'D)
Listen! Today's the most important day of your lives. You know how this department store only has one VVIC customer? Get ready to welcome her in!

EPISODE 34

44 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 44
(EMPLOYEE A, EMPLOYEES A & B, EVA, STORE MANAGER)

Employees A and B exchange a look, surprised.

EMPLOYEE A
You mean that customer who sends her personal shopper to buy millions worth of clothes every year?

The Store Manager fusses.

STORE MANAGER
This VVIC is our most honored customer across the world. Her experience will change your life! Bring your A game!

EMPLOYEES A & B
(excitedly)
Yes, sir!

The Store Manager smiles, satisfied, but his smile quickly fades as he notices Eva standing up.

STORE MANAGER
(disdainfully)
Ugh, you can start with getting this dumpster fire out of here.

Employees A and B approach to drive Eva away.

Eva puts her hand in her pocket.

EVA
(sneering)
Wanna kick me out? You're gonna regret it!

CLOSE-UP: Eva's about to pull out the VVIC card... *

EPISODE 35

45 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 45
(EMPLOYEES A & B, EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

Linda arrives, dressed seductively and dripping with gems. The Store Manager's eyes light up, and he quickly pushes Eva aside, hurrying to greet Linda subserviently.

STORE MANAGER
Perfectly coordinated wardrobe, gorgeous jewelry... you must be our * VVIC! *

Linda narrows her eyes, smiling cunningly.

LINDA (V.O.)
I'm no VVIC, but playing along * wouldn't hurt.

Linda nods proudly at the Store Manager.

LINDA
Linda Clark, your VVIC. *

Eva is shocked. The Store Manager is overjoyed.

STORE MANAGER
With our greatest pleasure, my * VVIC. *
(to Employees A and B)
What are you waiting for?

Employees A and B offer a glass of sparkling water for Linda.

EMPLOYEES A & B
Welcome, Miss Clark!

Linda preens, accepting the adulation, then notices Eva.

LINDA
(displeased)
Eva? What are you doing here?

Eva steps forward.

EVA
(angrily)
I should be asking you. I'm the VVIC here!

EPISODE 36

46 EXT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 46
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER)

Linda pauses for a second, then bursts out laughing, with the Store Manager and Employees A and B joining in.

EMPLOYEE A
You? A piece of trash calling yourself the VVIC?

EVA
(furious)
I really am...

Before she can finish, Linda loudly cuts her off.

LINDA
(spitefully)
Eva, even though you have a rich husband, you're not far from being kicked out of their family. Better save your money.

Employee A sucks up to Linda, caressing her handbag.

EMPLOYEE A
Faking won't hide her cheapness. Look at this limited-edition crocodile leather handbag from Hermes.
(looking at Eva)
You couldn't afford it even if you sold your body!

Eva sneers.

EVA
You sure that's a Hermes bag? The chief designer sends me a dozen bags a year. That must be one of the lower-tier designs.

Linda frowns, her tone sinister.

LINDA
(passive aggressive)
Eva, are you trying to break the record for the world's biggest liar?

The Store Manager quickly soothes Linda.

STORE MANAGER
(apologetically)
Miss Linda, please don’t get upset. I'll have security remove her immediately.

The Store Manager turns serious, looking towards the entrance.

STORE MANAGER (CONT’D)
Guards!

A few Security Guards start coming in, but...

EVA
Wait!

Eva holds up her VVIC card. *

EVA (CONT’D)
Surely you recognize this.

The Store Manager, Employees A and B, and Linda are all shocked.

EPISODE 37

47 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 47
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

The manager looks embarrassed.

STORE MANAGER
There’s only one copy in the world. Could this humble-looking lady really be our VVIC? *

Employees A and B exchange glances.

EMPLOYEE A
Our VVIC has orders here over a million every year. No way she would dress like this! *

The Store Manager is also uncertain, glancing hesitantly at Linda.

STORE MANAGER
Miss Linda, may I see your VVIC card? *

Linda avoids eye contact, and starts looking in her bag.

LINDA
(guiltily)
Of course, give me a second.

Employee B suddenly gets an idea.

EMPLOYEE A
I know what to do!

Everyone turns to look at Employee A.

EMPLOYEE A (CONT'D)
There's a private lounge exclusively for the VVIC. The card isn't just for payment. It's also for access. *

STORE MANAGER
(suddenly understanding)
That's right, only a VVIC card can open the lounge door. We can test both your cards, and see which one of you is real! *

Linda grows increasingly nervous, gritting her teeth.

LINDA (V.O.)
Damn it. I don't have this damn VVIC card. I have to get rid of Eva quickly! * *

The Store Manager approaches with an apologetic smile.

STORE MANAGER
Miss Clark, please do us a favor. Just try your card out.

Employee A sucks up to her.

EMPLOYEE A
Yes, show this poser what's real.

Linda's tight grip on her handbag betrays her inner anxiety.

LINDA
(nervously)
I'd rather not...

Eva steps up to Linda, staring into her eyes threateningly.

EVA
Swiping a card shouldn't be a big deal, yet you're so nervous.
(waving her card)
Linda... don't tell me you're actually the poser here?

EPISODE 38

48 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 48
(EVA, LINDA) *

Linda tries to act nonchalant as she turns and strides away.

LINDA
(gritting her teeth)
Who says I'm nervous? Let's go to that dumb lounge.

Eva calls out to her, pointing in the opposite direction.

EVA
Wrong way! Over there.

Linda stomps her foot as she turns around.

LINDA
Dammit!

Eva confidently follows behind her, smiling. A JANITOR (female, 50s) in the distance sees this scene.

49 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, OUTSIDE LOUNGE - DAY 49 *
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

Eva, holding her VVIC card, along with Employee A, B, and the * Store Manager, surround Linda as she rummages through her bag.

EVA
(looking at her watch, mocking)
Come on Linda, your bag's not that big. You've been searching for half an hour.

CLOSE-UP: Sweat drips down Linda's forehead.

LINDA
(irritated)
Stop rushing me. The VVIC card is precious. I have to be delicate.

Linda keeps pretending to search her bag. Eva sneers.

The Store Manager also gradually becomes anxious.

STORE MANAGER
(suspiciously)
Miss Clark, you... do have the card, don't you?

EMPLOYEE A
My dear Ms. Clark, please find the VVIC card, so you can bust this cheap fraud.

Linda fumbles her bag all over the place. Eva smirks.

EVA
You've been searching in the purse ten times in half an hour.

The Manager becomes anxious too. Linda's expression betrays her guilt. Eva steps forward.

EVA (CONT'D)
(smiling)
Get out of the way if you can't open the door.

Eva's confident expression is frozen.

EPISODE 39

50 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, OUTSIDE LOUNGE - DAY 50
(EVA, JANITOR, LINDA, STORE MANAGER)

CLOSE-UP: Eva is about to tap the VVIC card.

JANITOR (O.S.)
Wait a moment!

Everyone turns to look. The Janitor from before comes over.

STORE MANAGER
(impatiently)
What is the janitor doing here?
Stay away!

The Janitor walks up to Linda and hands her a card.

JANITOR
I saw the lady dropped this card when I was doing some cleaning just now. It looks very important. Please take care of it.

Linda takes it, looks down. It's the VVIC CARD! *

LINDA
Oh, of course I must have dropped it!

Eva's expression is surprised.

EVA (V.O.)
How is that possible?

Linda lowers her head and whispers into the Janitor's ear.

LINDA
(in a low voice)
You saved me, mom!

The Janitor smiles and nods. Linda taps the VVIC card on the * card reader. The door opens. *

LINDA (CONT'D) *
Viola. *

Freeze frame on Eva full of confidence. *

EPISODE 40

51 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, OUTSIDE LOUNGE - DAY 51
(EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

The Store Manager sighs with relief.

STORE MANAGER
I told you she's the real deal.
(looks at Eva, fiercely)
What do you have more words, poser?

Employee A shakes their head. Eva waves her hand to stop them.

EVA
Wait a minute!

Eva steps forward.

EVA (CONT'D)
This lounge is so unique and exclusive. Someone as ordinary as me... It would mean the world to me to have a look inside.

Linda puffs up her chest.

LINDA
Alright, I'll let you see for yourself that you and I are earth and heaven.

52 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VIC LOUNGE - DAY 52 *
(AI VOICE, EMPLOYEE B, EVA, LINDA, MANAGER) *

Linda leads Eva, the Employees, the Janitor, and the Store Manager into the room.

EMPLOYEE B
(with a pained expression)
It's so hot in here... Please feel free to turn on the AC.

Linda casually picks up the remote control on the table and presses a few buttons.

LINDA
(frowning)
Why doesn't this remote control work? *

Eva steps forward.

EVA
(sneering)
That remote isn't for the AC. *

Linda becomes impatient. *

LINDA *
This is so dumb! Aren't all AC *
controlled by a remote? *

The Manager tries to sugar coat with a polite smile. *

MANAGER *
A lowlife like her with not even *
500 dollars in her pockets *
wouldn’t know better. *

Eva steps forward and speaks loudly towards the ceiling.

EVA
Siri, turn on the AC, please!

As soon as she finishes speaking, an AI voice sounds.

AI VOICE (V.O.)
Welcome, Diamond VIC. The air *
conditioning is now on.

The Store Manager, Employee A and B are surprised. Eva looks at Linda.

EVA
Voice controls are standard in lounges now. Don't tell me you've never been to such an upscale mall before...

Linda is embarrassed, her guilty expression frozen.

EPISODE 41

53 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VIC LOUNGE - DAY 53 *
(EMPLOYEE A, EVA, JANITOR, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

The Store Manager and Employees all look at Linda with suspicion. Linda's gaze is shifty.

The Janitor steps forward.

JANITOR
(head bowed, modest)
It's probably because Miss Clark rarely goes shopping in person...

The Store Manager suddenly claps his hands.

STORE MANAGER
(enlightened)
Ah! That's right. Ms. Clark always sent a personal shopper! Why bother coming to the mall herself?

Employee A quickly agrees.

EMPLOYEE A
This is even her first time coming to our store!

Linda immediately regains her confidence upon hearing this.

LINDA
(smugly)
I don't bother with American malls. I prefer the shopping streets of London and Paris.

Employee A points at Eva, with a fierce expression.

EMPLOYEE A
(viciously)
You just turned the AC on with pure luck. Trying to make Miss Clark look bad? That’s shooting yourself in the foot!

STORE MANAGER
Get her out of here!

Employee A and B step forward, grabbing and restraining Eva.

EVA
(angrily)
Let go of me!

Linda waves her hand.

LINDA
Let her go!

Employee A and B pause and release Eva. Linda walks up to Eva, lifting her chin.

LINDA (CONT’D)
As long as you admit you were lying, apologize to me, and crawl out of here, maybe I’ll forgive you.

Eva shakes off Linda's hand.

EVA
(furious)
Lets see who’s the liar here, And you who needs the forgiveness.

LINDA
(sneering)
Try me.

Eva walks to the table, pointing at a rectangular box covered in a white cloth.

EVA
Under this white cloth, there's a safe. I set the password, and no one else in the world knows it!

Eva suddenly lifts the white cloth, and sure enough, a safe is revealed! Employee A and B exchange a glance.

EMPLOYEE A
How does she know there's a safe underneath?

Eva looks at Linda.

EVA
If you're truly the VVIC, you should know what's inside this safe!

Linda's expression is shocked.

EPISODE 42

54 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VIC LOUNGE - DAY 54 *
(EMPLOYEE A, EMPLOYEE B, EVA, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

Everyone turns to look at Linda, who looks guilty.

LINDA
(stammering)
This... this kind of safe, I have thousands of them. How could I remember all the passwords?

Eva smiles.

EVA
You may have forgotten the password, but surely you couldn't forget what's inside. In case I open it in a second, you'll call it "pure luck" again.

Linda bites her lip, and hesitates before answering.

LINDA
What else would be inside besides my most precious jewels?

Employee A chimes in to help.

EMPLOYEE A
Yes. What else could it be? A pile of stupid T-shirts?

The Store Manager and Employee B let out mocking laughter. Linda also laughs, regaining her confidence. Eva holds a poker face.

EVA
Of course not, but it’s not cash or jewelry either. It's an artificial rose, from Kevin ,my ex-husband, when he was down on his luck.

Linda furrows her brow. Employees A, B, and the Store Manager are surprised. Eva enters the password in front of everyone.

EMPLOYEE B
(horrified)
She really knows the password!

With a BEEP, the safe opens. Eva takes out a PLASTIC ROSE and holds it high for everyone to see!

STORE MANAGER
(shocked)
Oh my god!

EPISODE 43

55 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VVIC LOUNGE - DAY 55 *
(EMPLOYEE A, EMPLOYEE B, EVA, JANITOR, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

Eva tosses the rose into the trash, then walks up to Linda.

EVA
Anything else to say, Miss Clark?

Linda is guilty, lowering her head without a word. Employee A is full of regret.

EMPLOYEE A *
Did I really get it wrong? She’s * the actual VVIC? *

Employ B gasps in shock. *

EMPLOYEE B *
Jesus. We just insulted our VVIC? *

The janitor steps forward and takes Linda's hand.

JANITOR
(in a low voice)
Linda, that’s enough. Come home with mommy.

Linda suddenly looks up and points at the janitor.

LINDA
(ferocious)
It was you! You’ve been in cahoots with this woman. You put that plastic rose in the safe just to humiliate me!

JANITOR
(panicked)
I am your mother! How could you accuse me like this!

Linda pushes the janitor to the ground.

EVA *
Linda! How can you treat her like this?! *

LINDA
(screaming)
I'm Linda Clark! My mother isn’t a janitor!

STORE MANAGER
Pretending to be our VVIC and colluding with our staff, go rot in jail! *

Eva breaks free with force.

EVA
(panting)
I've texted Hunter Gordon, he'll be here soon.

Store Manager slaps Eva in the face. *

STORE MANAGER *
This is over for you! *

Eva stands up straight. *

EVA *
(sneering)
We'll see who's over in three, two, *
one...

56 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VIC LOUNGE - DAY 56 *
(EMPLOYEE A, HUNTER, LINDA, STORE MANAGER) *

The door opens, and Hunter enters charismatically with a team of SECURITY GUARDS. (Series of CLOSE-UPs)

The Store Manager and Employees approach him, fawning.

EMPLOYEE A
Mr. Gordon, this woman is
pretending to be the VVIC! *

STORE MANAGER
She and this janitor are committing
fraud! I already awarded her a
bitch slap.

Hunter glances at Eva, then turns to look at the employees. Hunter swings his arm and viciously slaps the Store Manager!

HUNTER
(angrily)
You idiot! She is the real VVIC! *
(to Eva) *
Ms. Miller, please take a seat, Let *
me handle it. *

He then slaps Employee A and B in succession. Employee B slaps Employee A back! Linda, Employees A, B, and the Store Manager are shocked.

LINDA
(horrified)
What?! Eva... she's the heiress of
the Miller family?!

EPISODE 44

57 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, VVIC LOUNGE - DAY 57 *
(HUNTER) *

Hunter points at Linda and turns to the guards.

HUNTER
What are you all standing there
for, throw that woman out!

Linda screams as the guards mercilessly drag her out!

58 EXT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, ENTRANCE - DAY 58
(LINDA, THOMPSON) *

Linda is thrown to the ground. The Guards coldly leave. Linda stands up, stomping her feet angrily. Thompson happens to be passing by and sees Linda.

THOMPSON
Linda, what are you doing here?

Linda falls into Thompson's arms and starts crying.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
Who hurt you? Tell me and I'll go after them!

LINDA
(sobbing)
It's Eva... she's... a Miller. THE Miss Miller!

59 ~~EXT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, ENTRANCE - DAY~~ 59 *

Thompson pushes Linda away, shocked.

THOMPSON
What? She's just my brother's gold-digging contract marriage bride.

LINDA
(sobbing)
Hunter Gordon said so himself...

Thompson sighs in relief.

THOMPSON
Oh, him. Don't you remember? Eva helped him out at the Jones gala.

Linda suddenly stops crying.

LINDA
Right! That's why Hunter was protecting her. They're conspiring!

THOMPSON
You see, there's no way she could be THE Miss Miller!

Linda's face is gradually filled with renewed confidence.

LINDA
(gritting her teeth)
That bitch fooled me again!

Thompson caresses Linda's cheek.

THOMPSON
Don't worry, I'm planning a big move with Ms. Anna Smith. Both Eva and my idiot brother are going down.

Linda coyly hooks Thompson's tie with her little finger.

LINDA
And the heir of the Jones family will be you!

Thompson snatches off the tie and tosses it to the ground. He picks Linda up and walks away into the bushes/forest.

THOMPSON
(charmingly)
And you'll be Mrs. Jones!

They leave, laughter echoing through the street.

EPISODE 45

60 INT. MILLER DEPARTMENT STORE, CLOTHING STORE - DAY 60
(EVA, RYAN) *

Ryan walks in while looking at his watch.

RYAN
Eva, sorry I took so long...

Ryan looks up to see Eva standing in front of the mirror, wearing a gorgeous dress.

EVA
(concerned)
Ryan? *

Ryan is frozen in place. *

MONTAGE: *

Fantasy Sequence: Ryan pins Eva against the wall and leans in for a kiss. * *

EVA (V.O.) *
Ryan? *

END OF MONTAGE *

Ryan snaps out of it. Eva turns back to face the mirror. *

EVA
Could you please help me with the zipper?

Ryan takes a deep breath and steps forward. *

CLOSE-UP: His fingertips touch Eva's back. His Adam's apple bobs, Eva bites her lip.

RYAN
Eva...

EVA
Hmm?

RYAN
Tomorrow's project bidding... it’s very important to me. Might I be graced with the honor of your company?

Eva turns around, happily nodding.

EVA
(smiling)
Of course.

EPISODE 46

63 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 63
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, KEVIN) *

In a large conference room, 7-8 GUESTS are gathered.

Eva links arms with Ryan as they enter. The Guests see them and start pointing and whispering. Eva and Ryan notice.

EVA
(frowning)
Something’s off.

At this moment, the main doors open. Anna strides in, wearing an elegant outfit, drawing everyone's attention.

GUEST A
(admiring)
Her presence is almost as stunning as Ms. Miller.

GUEST B
She looks determined to win the bid today!

Anna puffs up with pride as she strides amidst the compliments towards Ryan and Eva.

ANNA
(glancing at Eva)
See, Ryan? This woman and I are worlds apart.

Ryan looks annoyed.

ANNA (CONT'D)
(arrogantly)
I'm giving you one more chance. Divorce her and marry me!

Kevin saunters over and stands next to Anna.

KEVIN
(to Eva)
Looks like you're about to become a two-time divorcee!

Eva is slightly surprised.

EVA
(gritting her teeth)
Kevin? What are you doing here!

KEVIN
(smugly)
Thanks to Miss Smith, I'm on the rise again!

EVA
Ryan's different from a social climber like you. He won't let me down.

KEVIN
Ha! How can you be so confident, Eva? Look around at the socialites in New York, all paying their respect to Ms. Smith. How can you even compare?

The Guests nod in agreement. Anna shines a victorious smile. Eva turns to look at Ryan.

EVA
Alright, then let's see. Who will Mr. Jones choose in the end?

EPISODE 47

64 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 64
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, RYAN)

Ryan gently takes Eva's hand and smiles warmly.

RYAN
(resolute)
As long as I have Eva, I will never fold for any power.

Eva makes a subtle face at Anna. Anna's expression immediately darkens.

ANNA
Ryan! You ungrateful fool.

The guests start to look fearful after Anna’s ominous words.

GUEST A
Ms. Smith is warning him. The Jones family is doomed.

Ryan's expression is resolute.

RYAN
Anna, whatever tricks you play won’t never change my mind.

Anna snorts disdainfully.

ANNA
Then I’ll raze your family to the ground tonight! I’ll vanquish your family’s wealth and stature completely!

Eva steps forward.

EVA
(sneering)
What makes you think you can?

Anna doesn't respond, but smiles smugly and claps her hands.

ANNA
(loudly)
Come on out!

The doors open. Linda and Thompson enter smiling maliciously.

EPISODE 48

65 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 65
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, LINDA, RYAN) *

Anna introduces Linda proudly to everyone.

ANNA
This is Miss E, the best jewelry designer in the city.

The guests are shocked and start murmuring.

GUEST A
Oh my god, she won the world championship years ago.

GUEST B
Her pieces have sold for millions!

ANNA
(smugly)
Today's conference is about which project is more worth investing in. My esteemed investors... which will you choose?

GUEST A
The Smith Group, of course!

GUEST B
There’s no question!

GUEST A
But Miss E, companies have been begging you for years to come out of seclusion. Why choose the Smith Group?

Linda glances at Thompson.

LINDA
That’s all thanks to Thompson Jones.

Eva clenches her fists.

EVA (V.O.)
That liar. I'll expose her right now...

Ryan looks at Thompson, his expression furious.

RYAN
Thompson, you've betrayed me... betrayed the family!

EPISODE 49

66 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 66
(ANNA, GUEST A, GUEST B, GUEST C, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Thompson sneers.

THOMPSON
Not the family, just you. If you lose this bidding, Dad will know you're useless and favor me!

RYAN
(furious)
You...

THOMPSON
Don't worry, when you're kicked out on the streets, I'll be sure to scrape you off the pavement.

Ryan looks at the Guests with a pained expression.

RYAN
All of you... as president of the Jones Group, I've treated you well. And this is how you repay me?

The Guests look uncomfortable, exchanging glances. Anna smiles and gazes over everyone.

ANNA
Don't tell me you'd all like to make enemies of the Smiths!

GUEST A
(hastily)
The Howard family votes for the Smith Group!

GUEST B
The Weston family votes for the Smith Group!

GUEST C
(reluctant)
The Carver family also votes for the Smiths.

Ryan is shocked and furious. Eva looks anxious.

EPISODE 50

67 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 67
(ANNA, EVA, RYAN) *

Anna walks up to Ryan, her expression smug.

ANNA
How about it, Ryan? Wish you married me instead?

RYAN
Not a chance. The only thing I regret is not seeing through your true colors sooner!

EVA
Anna, Linda. Dare to make a bet?

All Guests present are stunned.

EVA (CONT'D)
I bet... the Jones Group will win today.

Anna, Kevin, and Linda look disdainful.

EPISODE 51

68 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 68 *
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, GUESTS, KEVIN, LINDA) *

Eva is about to continue speaking, but Ryan stops her. Anna steps forward, playing with the tassels on Eva's dress.

ANNA
What could possibly possess you to make a bet with me?

Eva brushes Anna's hand away, confidently announcing.

EVA
Because the real Miss E... is me!

Linda and Kevin evade.

LINDA
(whispers to Kevin)
Din’t you tell me you spent on fortune buying off Ms. E’s sketches? How come Eva suddenly claims to be her?

KEVIN
How would I know? Eva told me she bought them from a flea market. No way she is Ms. E. She’s bluffing! Don’t be fooled.

Guests A and B lower their heads, whispering.

GUEST A
Two Miss E’s? Let’s see who comes out on top.

Linda takes out a stack of DRAFTS from her bag.

LINDA
These are the original drafts from when I, Miss E, won the world finals last year.
(looks at Eva)
Where’s your proof?

EVA
I don’t have the draft with me, but I can prove Linda stole it from me.

ANNA
(disdainfully)
How do you expect to do that?

EVA
A simple contest. Miss Clark and I will draw these drafts from memory. We’ll compare the two, and see who’s the fake.

The Guests all shake their heads.

GUESTS
Do it! Do it!

Linda turns away to leave.

LINDA
(feigns nonchalance)
I won't play games with a lowlife like you.

Anna blocks Linda.

ANNA
Unfortunately, you're here representing the Smith Group today. You have to do it for our bid.

Linda's expression is guilty and anxious.

EPISODE 52

70 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 70
(ANNA, GUEST A, GUEST B, RYAN) *

Linda and Eva sit down at a table with paper and pens ready.

GUEST A
Pens at the ready... begin!

The two start drawing. Linda impatiently scribbles on the paper, while Eva occasionally furrows her brow and ponders.

GUEST A (CONT'D)
Linda's strokes are so quick, as if she doesn't need to think at all.

GUEST B
I'd say the best designers take their time..

SERIES OF SHOTS - Time passes...

Linda and Eva simultaneously put down their pens. The two drawings are then PROJECTED ONTO A LARGE SCREEN.

First is Linda's drawing, a chaotic mess. The hall erupts in laughter. Kevin and Thompson can't help but laugh too.

Linda's embarrassed and angry, she tries to run but is stopped by Guest A.

Eva's drawing is projected - neat and clever. The hall is filled with praise.

GUEST B (CONT'D)
No wonder her work's worth millions! Amazing!

Guest A walks up to Eva and raises her hand.

GUEST A
Eva Jones is the true Miss E!

Eva smiles. Ryan steps forward and embraces Eva.

RYAN
(excitedly)
Eva, you're full of surprises.

Anna is furious.

ANNA
(angrily)
It can't be... it can't be!

EPISODE 53

71 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 71
(ANNA, EVA, KEVIN, LINDA, THOMPSON) *

Linda slaps Kevin across the face.

LINDA
Useless jerk. It's all your fault!

Kevin is knocked to the ground by the slap.

KEVIN
I was just trying to help you!

LINDA
You only made things worse!

Linda clings to Thompson instead. Kevin struggles to get up.

KEVIN
You two?

LINDA
Took you a while to find out.

Thompson steps forward and kicks Kevin to the ground!

THOMPSON
You bankrupt has-been, wanna fight me for her?

Kevin falls to the ground, struggling to grab onto Anna's leg, but is mercilessly kicked away.

ANNA
(hisses, bared teeth)
Get out of here, you useless piece of shit. You've ruined everything. What are you waiting for, a reward?

Kevin is stunned for a moment, then looks at the distant Eva and Ryan, being affectionate. He bursts into tears.

KEVIN
I'm such a fool. Eva stood by me when I had nothing. While Linda cheated on me without a second thought. Karma's caught up to me today...

Kevin leaves the meeting hall, Guest A can't stop him. Eva pulls Ryan to the center of the hall.

EVA
(to the crowd)
The true Miss E has allied herself with the Jones Group. I think we know who the winner is here.

EPISODE 54

72 INT. BIDDING MEETING - DAY 72
(ANNA, EVA, GUEST A, GUEST B, GUEST C, LINDA, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

GUEST A
The Howard family supports the Jones Group!

GUEST B
The Weston family supports the Jones Group!

GUEST C
(enthusiastic)
The Busch family also supports the Joneses!

Eva and Ryan look at each other and smile in relief! Anna roars. She slaps Linda hard across the face.

ANNA
How dare you trick me! You humiliated me!

Linda covers her face and falls to the ground, wailing.

LINDA
It's not... I didn't mean to...
(looks at Thompson)
Thompson, explain yourself!

THOMPSON
(avoiding her gaze)
Don't drag me into this.

Thompson glares at Linda, then walks up to Anna with an apologetic smile.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
Anna, you know me. I didn't know she was a fraud.

Anna slaps Thompson hard across the face.

ANNA
Don't let me see you again. Security!

GUARDS drag the struggling and screaming Linda and Thompson out of the meeting hall.

Anna turns and points at Eva and Ryan.

ANNA (CONT'D)
Don't get cocky now. The Jones are nothing compared to the Smiths. I could destroy you without even blinking!

EVA
Is that so? But what if I oppose your decision on behalf of the Millers?

GUEST A
An alliance between the Jones and the Millers? Ten Smiths won't be able to stop them.

GUEST B
The Smiths would be done for.

RYAN
On behalf of the Millers? Eva, who are you?

Anna walks up to Eva.

ANNA
(sarcastic)
Oh yeah, I forgot. You're the Millers' daughter.

EVA
It doesn't matter what you believe. All will be revealed at the Lovers' Ball.

ANNA
(gritted teeth)
Alright, I'll see you there in three days. I'd love to see how you defend yourself in front of the real Miss Miller!

Anna turns and leaves. Eva smiles as she watches her go.

EPISODE 55

73 EXT. STREET - NIGHT 73
(EVA) *

Eva walks down the street, looking at her designs.

EVA
(thinking)
These designs may have won the bidding, but they're not perfect. I still need to work on them...

Suddenly, a burlap sack is thrown over her head from behind.

EVA (CONT'D)
(screams)
Help!

74 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 74
(EVA, LINDA) *

Eva wakes up. She's on the ground, hands and feet bound.

EVA
(terrified)
Hello? Somebody help!

Linda walks over to Eva's back, holding a dagger.

LINDA
(viciously)
You've gotten in my way too many times. Time for you to die.

Eva struggles.

EVA
You're crazy! You're the one who's been harassing me!

Linda's grip on the knife tightens.

LINDA
Blablabla.
(gritting her teeth)
Don't challenge me, bitch. I'm at my limit!

EPISODE 56

75 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 75 *
(EVA, LINDA)

Eva is helpless.

EVA
You've gone too far, Linda! Why do you hate me so much?

Linda approaches.

LINDA
What do you think? If it weren't for you, I'd be the wife of a CEO by now.

EVA
It's not my fault you lied your way to the top!

LINDA
(hysterical)
It's all your fault! If you didn't hide your identity, how could I be exposed?

QUICK FLASH: Scenes of Linda accusing her mother and conspiring with Leo.

LINDA (VO) (CONT'D)
My mom's just a janitor. My dad's a security guard. Do you know how hard I've worked to get where I am? *

FLASH BACK: *

76 INT. CITY HALL - DAY 76
(LINDA) *

Scene of Eva being humiliated and forced to divorce by Kevin.

LINDA (VO)
I'm not like you, you naturally talented genius designer. Everything comes easy to you! Even marrying that useless Kevin was just cuz you can!

BACK TO SCENE: *

77 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 77
(EVA, LINDA) *

Facing Linda's accusations, Eva struggles.

EVA
(derisive)
If you look down on Kevin so much, why bother seducing him back then?

A smug smile appears on Linda's face as she recalls the memories.

LINDA
Doesn't matter if it's Kevin or Thompson, I'll bed with whoever can help me break into the upper echelon!

Eva shakes her head.

EVA
But they both treat you like an object! Is that really worth it?

Linda is enraged, suddenly raising the knife to stab Eva.

LINDA
Shut up!

Eva screams.

EPISODE 57

78 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 78
(EVA, LINDA, RYAN) *

The knife stops just inches away from Eva's heart.

EVA
Will killing me get you to the top?

Linda puts away the dagger, smiling smugly.

LINDA
I'm not gonna kill you. I just want Ryan to transfer all his company shares to Thompson.

Eva is shocked.

EVA
You're forcing Ryan into bankruptcy. This will kill him!

Linda sneers.

LINDA
You think I care? It's you or him dying.

Just in time, Ryan rushes in.

RYAN
(urgently)
Eva!

Ryan tries to run over and save Eva. Linda immediately puts the knife to Eva's neck.

LINDA
Stay right where you are.

EPISODE 58

79 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 79
(EVA, LINDA, RYAN) *

The knife blade presses against Eva's neck, blood oozing out.

LINDA
(sternly)
Take one more step and say goodbye to your wife.

Ryan can only back away.

RYAN
I'll do anything you want.

Linda tosses a CONTRACT AND PEN in front of Ryan.

LINDA
Sign over all your shares in the Jones Group to Thompson. Or I'll kill her now!

Ryan is about to bend down to pick up the contract, but Eva suddenly stops him.

EVA
Wait!

Ryan pauses and withdraws his hand, Eva looks at Linda.

EVA (CONT'D)
Linda, do you remember, Ryan and I are just in a contract marriage. We're not real husband and wife. Ryan wouldn't sign this for me. Just let me go and we can forget this ever happened.

Linda is skeptical for a second, then suddenly slaps Eva hard across the face.

LINDA
Stop lying to me!! You really got a death wish?

Ryan steps forward anxiously.

RYAN
Don't touch her! I'll sign it.

EPISODE 59

80 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 80
(EVA, LINDA, POLICE OFFICER, RYAN) *

Eva struggles.

EVA
Ryan, don't!

Linda presses the knife against Eva's neck.

LINDA
Better get to it, or she’s a dead woman.

RYAN
(resolute)
I'll sign.

Ryan picks up the contract. Eva struggles desperately.

EVA
(urgently)
No! stop! Not for me!

Ryan starts signing the contract.

RYAN
(resolute)
Who cares about being the CEO?

After saying this, he puts down the pen and looks up at Eva.

RYAN (CONT’D)
(tenderly)
Nothing is more important to me than you.

Eva also looks at Ryan, anxious yet touched. Ryan shows the signed contract to Linda.

RYAN (CONT’D)
I've signed it. Now let her go.

Linda hesitates. Suddenly, POLICE OFFICERS rush in.

POLICE OFFICER
Drop your weapon!

EPISODE 60

81 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 81
(LINDA, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

The Police Officers snatch the knife from Linda's hand. Ryan immediately goes to untie Eva.

RYAN
(tenderly)
Are you alright?

Eva manages a weak smile and nods.

LINDA
(struggling)
Who called the police?

THOMPSON (O.S.)
I did!

Thompson strolls in, picking up the signed contract.

LINDA
(shocked and furious)
It was you? I was helping you!

Thompson slaps Linda hard across the face.

THOMPSON
Stupid bitch! Whatever you did has nothing to do with me!

Thompson points at Ryan and Eva.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
This woman kidnapped my brother's wife. Arrest her!

Thompson signals to the lead Police Officer, who immediately muzzles Linda and drags her out.

Ryan gestures for Eva to leave first. Eva reluctantly does. Thompson holds the contract, walking towards Ryan smugly.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
Looks like you've transferred all your share to me, Ryan. I'm the head of the family now!

Before he can finish, he notices Ryan clenching his fist.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
(cocky)
What are you gonna do about it?

Instantly, Ryan lands a hard punch on his face.

EPISODE 61

82 INT. ABANDONED CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 82
(RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Thompson wakes up, tied to a chair. Ryan stands before him.

THOMPSON
Ryan, what are you doing? I'm your brother!

Ryan's expression is serious.

RYAN
That you are. That’s why I won’t fight you for my shares. You can have them. But you hurt my wife!

Thompson struggles frantically.

THOMPSON
I’m sorry, alright?

Ryan grabs Thompson's hair and forces him to look at him.

RYAN
She's innocent. Your feud with me has nothing to do with her, understand?

Thompson nods repeatedly.

THOMPSON
Of course. I swear.

Ryan releases Thompson's hair.

RYAN
Now take a time out and think about what you’ve done.

Ryan turns and leaves. Thompson suddenly realizes something.

THOMPSON
Hey, you can’t leave me here!

He starts struggling frantically, shouting.

THOMPSON (CONT’D)
Help! Help!

84 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 84
(EVA, JONES SR., RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Ryan and Eva who is carrying a big package enter the room.

RYAN
(surprised)
What is this?

EVA
This is my first time having dinner with your family, so I have to bring a proper gift. And to make up for the misunderstanding earlier.

RYAN
Honey, you are so thoughtful. Let me help you carrying it. *

Ryan took the package from Eva hand.

Thompson, Jones Sr., and sister MAY are already seated, with one empty seat left. *

Thompson glances at them, speaking snidely.

THOMPSON
Ryan, I thought you wouldn't be here today.

Ryan apologizes.

RYAN
Sorry, there was traffic. Everyone, long time no see. * *
(looks around)
I think we need an extra chair.

Thompson puts his leg on the chair.

THOMPSON
No room for late arrivals.

Ryan's expression darkens.

RYAN
(serious)
Don't push your luck, bro.

Jones Sr. lights a cigar, looking at them with disdain.

THOMPSON
(snidely)
You brought your wife just to rub it in our face. How could you blow off Miss Smith and Miss Miller for her. You can't blame us for thinking less of you.

Ryan looks at his father in disbelief.

RYAN
Father, surely you don't agree.

Jones Sr. nods slowly.

JONES SR.
You chose a woman over your own family. You even gave your company shares to your brother. You've really disappointed me.

Ryan is shocked.

EPISODE 63

85 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 85
(EVA, JONES SR., MAY, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

JONES SR.
What if a hobo uses this woman to threaten you? Would you hand over the Jones family to them too?

Thompson is smug.

THOMPSON
I bet he would. This witch must have put a curse on him.

Thompson insults Eva, angering Ryan.

RYAN
Shut your mouth! *

Jones Sr. stands up, pointing at Ryan. *

JONES SR.
You have no right to speak against your brother! Remember our family motto - "Peritia praevalet affectibus".
(MORE)

JONES SR. (CONT'D)
Competence over emotions. Thompson has prevailed over you, fair and square.

Ryan's expression is furious. May stands up, trying to mediate. *

MAY
Oh, boys, let's not fight. I brought some exquisite French wines to cheer us up.

May goes to the door to fetch the wine. She notices the large box Eva brought.

MAY (CONT'D)
(surprised)
What's this?

EVA
(smiling)
A gift for my father-in-law.

Thompson sneers.

THOMPSON
Your husband's broke. What kind of gift could you possibly bring?

Eva smiles.

EVA
No worries. I have my own money.

Thompson, and Jones Sr. all have mocking expressions.

JONES SR.
Open it, then. I'm due for a good laugh.

Eva calmly unwraps the package and takes out a painting, standing it on the table.

EVA
(smiling)
This is my gift, a genuine Da Vinci masterpiece, 'Salvator Mundi'!

EPISODE 64

86 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 86
(EVA, JONES SR., MAY, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

May approaches, looking surprised.

MAY
Wow, this is a masterpiece from the same era as the "Mona Lisa," It’s worth at least 500 million! *

Jones Sr. looks uneasy. *

JONES SR.
Doesn’t the Saudi Arabian royalty own this? How did it end up in your hands?

EVA
(proudly)
My father and the Saudi king were good friends. This was a birthday present from the king.

May, Thompson, Jones Sr., and Ryan are all shocked. May hugs Eva. *

MAY
Eva, you're so generous! You’re hardly as bad as they say you are.

Eva smiles back at May.

THOMPSON
(sarcastic)
If this painting is real, you’re a fool to give it away.

JONES SR.
(disdainful)
I don't believe it.

Ryan laughs.

RYAN
Don't forget, Eva revealed herself as an internationally renowned jewelry designer.

This leaves Thompson and Jones Sr. are speechless. *

MAY
(admiring)
That’s impressive!

Thompson stands up.

THOMPSON
Not so fast, May. I haven’t even open my gift for you all.

Thompson claps, and two WAITERS enter, carrying a canvas covered in cloth.

Thompson unveils it, revealing an identical "Salvator Mundi" to Eva's.

JONES SR.
(Shocked)
Identical?!

Eva and Ryan exchange surprised glances.

EPISODE 65

87 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 87
(EVA, JONES SR., LILLY, MAY, THOMPSON) *

JONES SR.
(puzzled)
How could this be? There’s only one ‘Salvator Mundi’ in this world. If only your Aunt Lilly were here. She does art appraisals.

THOMPSON
Obviously mine is real, and this woman’s a liar.

Thompson smugly approaches Eva's painting. Thompson suddenly punches the canvas, creating a large hole. Eva is furious.

EVA
(angry)
You're insane!

THOMPSON
Put this forgery in the trash where it belongs!

Thompson tears the canvas apart, scraps fly everywhere! May tries to intervene but is pushed away.

MAY
(urgently)
You've gone too far, Thompson!

Eva suppresses her anger.

EVA
Whether you keep the gift or not, just make sure not to regret it.

Thompson smugly claps his hands. The room's door opens, revealing an elderly but sharp-eyed woman, LILLY (50s?).

LILLY
Apologies for the tardiness...

THOMPSON
Aunt Lily!

EPISODE 66

88 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 88
(LILLY, THOMPSON) *

Thompson puts on a smile, rushing to assist Lilly.

THOMPSON
Aunt Lilly, don't tell me you got carried away at another auction and forgot about our family gathering?

LILLY
(chuckling)
I made it here, didn't I?

Lilly notices Thompson's painting on the table.

LILLY (CONT'D)
(squinting)
What's this?

THOMPSON
This was a gift for my father...

Before Thompson can finish, Lilly cuts him off.

LILLY
Get that garbage off this table!

Lilly waves her hand dismissively.

LILLY (CONT'D)
You can buy these from Ross. Take it home if you like, but don't violate my eyes here. *

Ryan and Eva exchange amused glances.

Thompson glares at Eva and Ryan, then walks over to Lilly, holding the painting.

THOMPSON
Aunt Lilly, you must be mistaken. I spent a fortune on this. Take a closer look, please.

Lilly squints again.

LILLY
You might be right.

Thompson breathes a sigh of relief.

THOMPSON
There we go.

89 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 89
(LILLY) *

Lilly picks up a scrap of Eva's painting, stuck onto Thompson's painting.

LILLY
This piece is real!

Thompson tries to snatch the piece, panicked. Lilly stands up, holding the piece and walking around.

LILLY (CONT'D)
This is "Salvator Mundi" by Leonardo Da Vinci. But how did it end up in pieces?

Lilly takes a few steps, noticing more scraps on the floor, as well as the remaining frame from Eva's painting.

LILLY (CONT'D)
(heartbroken)
Oh dear, how terrible! Why did you rip up the real painting!

Jones Sr.and Thompson look surprised and embarrassed.

EPISODE 67

90 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 90
(EVA, JONES SR., LILLY, RYAN) *

Lilly picks up the pieces from the floor, her hands trembling, full of sorrow.

LILLY
Who did this?

Jones Sr. pushes Thompson out without hesitation. *

JONES SR.
Him, he tore it!

Lilly gives Thompson a fierce slap.

LILLY
You blind fool. This is the greatest painting in the world, and you've destroyed it?!

Lilly picks up the fake painting on the table and smashes it on the floor.

LILLY (CONT'D)
And left a fake in its place!

Lilly points at Thompson and Jones Sr..

LILLY (CONT'D)
You trust this imbecile to lead our family?

Eva sighs with relief, May looks triumphant. Ryan steps forward to support Aunt Lilly. Two waiters bring out a chair for Eva and she sits down with Ryan.

RYAN
Aunty, don't be upset. Sit down and have some dinner.

LILLY
(still angry)
I have no appetite. An invaluable treasure, ruined!

Jones Sr. clears his throat.

JONES SR.
Eva, I admit you've proven yourself as a renowned designer as well as offering a genuine Da Vinci to us, but you still can't compare to the Millers' daughter.

Eva steps forward.

EVA
(smiling)
If I can get my hands on the authentic Salvador Mundi, don’t you think I could bring Ryan back to the throne as well?

Jones Sr., Thompson and Ryan are shocked.

EPISODE 68

91 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 91
(EVA, LILLY, RYAN, THOMPSON) *

THOMPSON
(disdainful)
You? You can’t even afford this meal. Stop bluffing!

Eva chuckles coldly.

EVA
How do you know I can't afford it?

Thompson smugly takes out a PRIVATE CLUB MEMBERSHIP CARD.

THOMPSON
This private club is referral only. You need a membership card to make any purchase here.

Lilly steps forward to comfort Eva.

LILLY
Don't worry, Aunt Lilly will pay for you.

Ryan goes to stand next to Eva.

RYAN
No, I’ll do it.

Thompson slams the table, shouting.

THOMPSON
As the CEO of Jones Group, I order none of you to help her!

EVA
(confidently)
I don't need anyone's help!

A waiter enters, carrying a POS machine and approaching Eva.

Eva snatches the POS machine from the waiter's hand, taking a card from her pocket and swiping it.

THOMPSON
(urgently)
What are you doing? Swiping external cards will damage the system!

Thompson seizes the opportunity to stoke the fire.

THOMPSON (CONT'D)
Call the police. Arrest her!

Almost simultaneously, the entire restaurant is filled with a PIERCING ALARM sound.

EPISODE 69

92 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 92
(AI VOICE, EVA, HOTEL MANAGER, POLICE OFFICER, THOMPSON) *

AI VOICE
Attention all staff. The SVIP has arrived. Attention all staff... *

The HOTEL MANAGER bursts in, panting.

HOTEL MANAGER
Where is she? Who just used the SVIP card? * *

The Waiter gestures to the Hotel Manager, indicating Eva. Hotel Manager understands, bowing deeply.

HOTEL MANAGER (CONT'D)
Esteemed guest, thank you for dining here today. Of course, everything is on the house. *

Thompson is shocked. *

THOMPSON
She's the SVIP? *

Thompson's expression is anxious.

THOMPSON (V.O.)
I heard the only SVIP was the Millers' daughter. How is this possible? *

Eva stops the manager.

EVA
There's no need to waive the bill. The Jones here were just fighting for the bill.

Thompson's expression is embarrassed, but he steps forward stubbornly.

THOMPSON
(feigning nonchalance)
It's just a meal. I got this.

Thompson hands over his card. HOTEL MANAGER swipes it.

HOTEL MANAGER
(frowning)
Sir, it seems your card has been declined...

THOMPSON
(shocked)
What?!

At this moment, several Policemen charge in, two of them immediately restraining Thompson.

POLICE OFFICER
Thompson Jones, you're under arrest for financial fraud!

EPISODE 70

93 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY 93
(RYAN, THOMPSON) *

Eva and Ryan exchange a smile.

THOMPSON
(struggling)
Ryan, I'm your brother, how could you do this to me!

Ryan sneers.

RYAN
Like you said. Survival of the fittest in the Jones family. Thompson could never be a good leader.

Jones Sr.,furious but speechless, leaves the hotel room.

94 INT. HOTEL, PRIVATE ROOM - DAY (LATER) 94

Ryan pulls Eva to sit down.

RYAN
(gently)
Now, no one will hurt you anymore. But... I'm worried about Miss Miller. She may still give you trouble.

EVA
Don't worry, she won't.

RYAN
But I promise, I'll persuade her at the Lovers' Ball tomorrow. I'll never let you down like Kevin did.

Eva nods seriously, smiling.

EVA (V.O.)
You stubborn man. No matter, the truth will be revealed tomorrow.

EPISODE 71

95 INT. LOVERS' BALL - DAY 95

The Important Guests are chatting when Kevin passes by.

IMPORTANT GUEST A
Kevin Brown! I'm surprised you're willing to show your face here.

Kevin looks embarrassed.

IMPORTANT GUEST B
(mocking)
The Brown Company's bankrupt. He's got nothing to lose.

Kevin puts on a nonchalant front.

KEVIN
Laugh all you want. When I marry Miss Miller, I'll get back at all of you one by one!

Anna walks past the group.

IMPORTANT GUEST A
Miss Smith is here, but where's Miss Miller?

The door opens, and Ryan strides in.

96 INT. LOVERS' BALL - DAY 96

IMPORTANT GUEST B
Looks like he’s the most promising suitor tonight.

IMPORTANT GUEST A
At the Jones gala, he said he wouldn’t come. I suppose he’s abandoned his poor wife.

IMPORTANT GUEST B
They say money can’t buy love, but love can’t buy money.

Kevin laughs smugly.

KEVIN
Poor Eva just can’t hold down a man.

Suddenly, the hall's lights dim. A spotlight SHINES...

On the stage, a girl in a luxurious dress stands with her back to the audience.

KEVIN (CONT’D)
(infatuated)
She's beautiful!

IMPORTANT GUEST A
(stammering)
Miss Miller... it’s her!

Kevin rushes forward, kneeling on one knee.

KEVIN
Please marry me, miss!

IMPORTANT GUEST A, B, C, D also rush up, kneeling one by one.

IMPORTANT GUEST A
(urgently)
No, please marry me! I'll make you the happiest woman in the world!

IMPORTANT GUEST B
Miss, you must marry me!

Ryan looks over at the stage. The girl on stage slowly turns around - it's Eva.

Ryan is shocked.

RYAN
Eva, what are you doing here?

EPISODE 72

97 INT. LOVERS' BALL - DAY 97

The others, hearing this, raise their heads and stand up.

KEVIN
Eva? All along, it was really her?

Ryan steps forward.

RYAN
You weren’t lying.

Eva nods and smiles. The Important Guests start proposing again, speaking over each other.

IMPORTANT GUESTS
(overlapping)
Miss Miller, marry me! / I'll make you happy! / Marry me!

Eva walks through them to stand in front of Ryan.

EVA
(smiling)
Sorry, boys. I’m taken.

Kevin rushes over, blocking them.

KEVIN
(urgently)
Eva, I'm sorry for everything. Let’s get back together!

Eva pushes Kevin away.

EVA
Past tense. You said it yourself.

Eva steps forward, taking Ryan's hand.

EVA (CONT'D)
He's the only for me.

Ryan sweeps Eva up in a princess carry, spinning her around.

THE END *